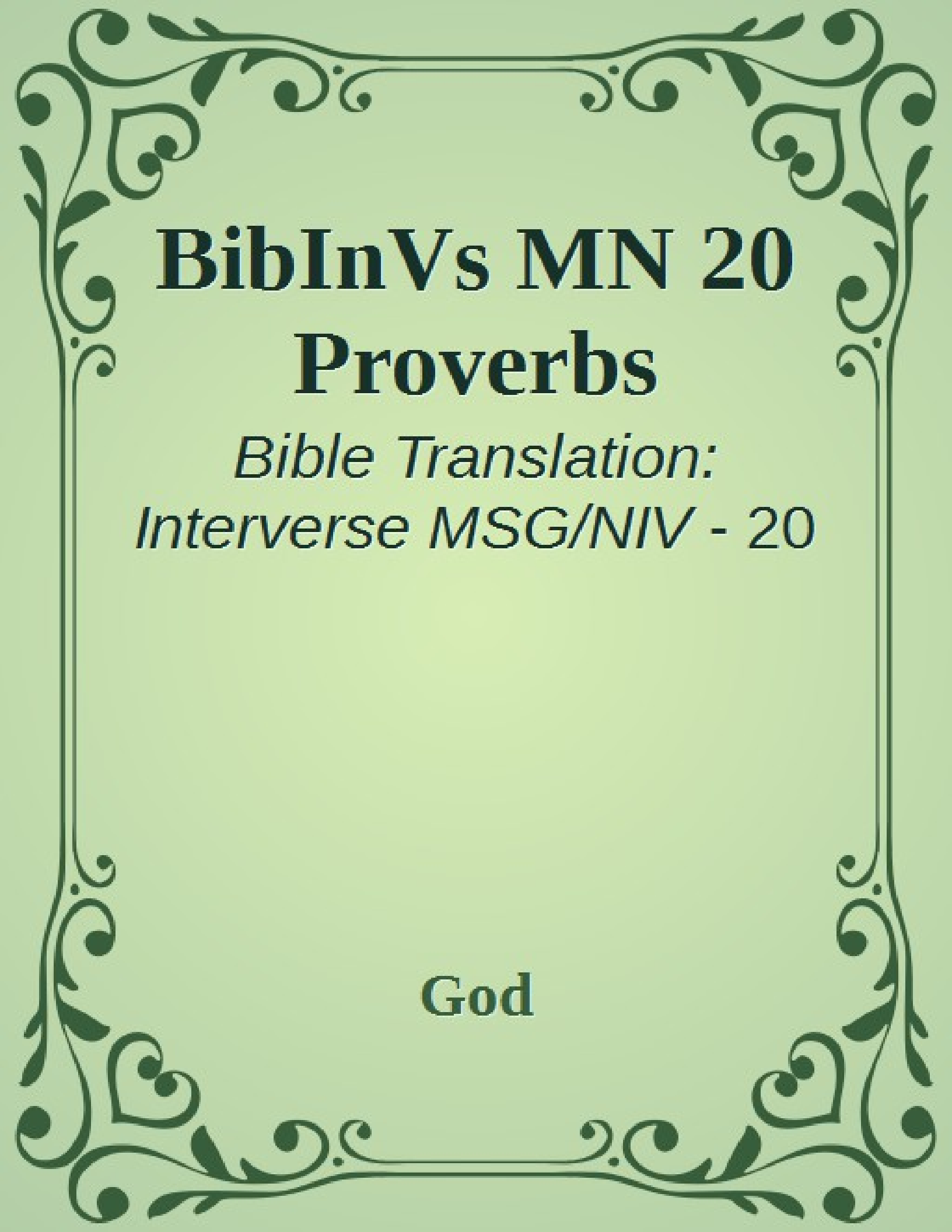


A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 20

Proverbs

Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 20

God

Table of Contents

Proverbs 1
Proverbs 2
Proverbs 3
Proverbs 4
Proverbs 5
Proverbs 6
Proverbs 7
Proverbs 8
Proverbs 9
Proverbs 10
Proverbs 11
Proverbs 12
Proverbs 13
Proverbs 14
Proverbs 15
Proverbs 16
Proverbs 17
Proverbs 18
Proverbs 19
Proverbs 20
Proverbs 21
Proverbs 22
Proverbs 23
Proverbs 24
Proverbs 25
Proverbs 26
Proverbs 27
Proverbs 28
Proverbs 29
Proverbs 30
Proverbs 31

Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Proverbs

Proverbs 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the wise sayings of Solomon, David's son, Israel's king--
- 1 The proverbs of Solomon son of David, king of Israel:
- 2 Written down so we'll know how to live well and right, to understand what life means and where it's going;
- 2 for attaining wisdom and discipline; for understanding words of insight;
- 3 A manual for living, for learning what's right and just and fair;
- 3 for acquiring a disciplined and prudent life, doing what is right and just and fair;
- 4 To teach the inexperienced the ropes and give our young people a grasp on reality.
- 4 for giving prudence to the simple, knowledge and discretion to the young--
- 5 There's something here also for seasoned men and women,
- 5 let the wise listen and add to their learning, and let the discerning get guidance--
- 6 still a thing or two for the experienced to learn-- Fresh wisdom to probe and penetrate, the rhymes and reasons of wise men and women.
- 6 for understanding proverbs and parables, the sayings and riddles of the wise.
- 7 Start with GOD--the first step in learning is bowing down to GOD; only fools thumb their noses at such wisdom and learning.
- 7 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of knowledge, but fools despise wisdom and discipline.
- 8 Pay close attention, friend, to what your father tells you; never forget what you learned at your mother's knee.
- 8 Listen, my son, to your father's instruction and do not forsake your mother's teaching.

9 Wear their counsel like flowers in your hair, like rings on your fingers.
9 They will be a garland to grace your head and a chain to adorn your neck.
10 Dear friend, if bad companions tempt you, don't go along with them.
10 My son, if sinners entice you, do not give in to them.
11 If they say--"Let's go out and raise some hell. Let's beat up some old man, mug some old woman.
11 If they say, "Come along with us; let's lie in wait for someone's blood, let's waylay some harmless soul;
12 Let's pick them clean and get them ready for their funerals.
12 let's swallow them alive, like the grave, and whole, like those who go down to the pit;
13 We'll load up on top-quality loot. We'll haul it home by the truckload.
13 we will get all sorts of valuable things and fill our houses with plunder;
14 Join us for the time of your life! With us, it's share and share alike!"--
14 throw in your lot with us, and we will share a common purse"--
15 Oh, friend, don't give them a second look; don't listen to them for a minute.
15 my son, do not go along with them, do not set foot on their paths;
16 They're racing to a very bad end, hurrying to ruin everything they lay hands on.
16 for their feet rush into sin, they are swift to shed blood.
17 Nobody robs a bank with everyone watching,
17 How useless to spread a net in full view of all the birds!
18 Yet that's what these people are doing-- they're doing themselves in.
18 These men lie in wait for their own blood; they waylay only themselves!
19 When you grab all you can get, that's what happens: the more you get, the less you are.
19 Such is the end of all who go after ill-gotten gain; it takes away the lives of those who get it.
20 Lady Wisdom goes out in the street and shouts. At the town center she makes her speech.
20 Wisdom calls aloud in the street, she raises her voice in the public squares;
21 In the middle of the traffic she takes her stand. At the busiest corner she calls out:

21 at the head of the noisy streets she cries out, in the gateways of the city
she makes her speech:

22 "Simpletons! How long will you wallow in ignorance? Cynics! How
long will you feed your cynicism? Idiots! How long will you refuse to
learn?

22 How long will you simple ones love your simple ways? How long will
mockers delight in mockery and fools hate knowledge?

23 About face! I can revise your life. Look, I'm ready to pour out my spirit
on you; I'm ready to tell you all I know.

23 If you had responded to my rebuke, I would have poured out my heart
to you and made my thoughts known to you.

24 As it is, I've called, but you've turned a deaf ear; I've reached out to you,
but you've ignored me.

24 But since you rejected me when I called and no one gave heed when I
stretched out my hand,

25 "Since you laugh at my counsel and make a joke of my advice,
25 since you ignored all my advice and would not accept my rebuke,

26 How can I take you seriously? I'll turn the tables and joke about your
troubles!

26 I in turn will laugh at your disaster; I will mock when calamity
overtakes you--

27 What if the roof falls in, and your whole life goes to pieces? What if
catastrophe strikes and there's nothing to show for your life but rubble
and ashes?

27 when calamity overtakes you like a storm, when disaster sweeps over
you like a whirlwind, when distress and trouble overwhelm you.

28 You'll need me then. You'll call for me, but don't expect an answer. No
matter how hard you look, you won't find me.

28 Then they will call to me but I will not answer; they will look for me
but will not find me.

29 "Because you hated Knowledge and had nothing to do with the Fear-of-
GOD,

29 Since they hated knowledge and did not choose to fear the LORD,

30 Because you wouldn't take my advice and brushed aside all my offers to
train you,

30 since they would not accept my advice and spurned my rebuke,

- 31 Well, you've made your bed--now lie in it; you wanted your own way--now, how do you like it?
- 31 they will eat the fruit of their ways and be filled with the fruit of their schemes.
- 32 Don't you see what happens, you simpletons, you idiots? Carelessness kills; complacency is murder.
- 32 For the waywardness of the simple will kill them, and the complacency of fools will destroy them;
- 33 First pay attention to me, and then relax. Now you can take it easy--you're in good hands."
- 33 but whoever listens to me will live in safety and be at ease, without fear of harm."

Proverbs 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Good friend, take to heart what I'm telling you; collect my counsels and guard them with your life.
- 1 My son, if you accept my words and store up my commands within you,
- 2 Tune your ears to the world of Wisdom; set your heart on a life of Understanding.
- 2 turning your ear to wisdom and applying your heart to understanding,
- 3 That's right--if you make Insight your priority, and won't take no for an answer,
- 3 and if you call out for insight and cry aloud for understanding,
- 4 Searching for it like a prospector panning for gold, like an adventurer on a treasure hunt,
- 4 and if you look for it as for silver and search for it as for hidden treasure,
- 5 Believe me, before you know it Fear-of-GOD will be yours; you'll have come upon the Knowledge of God.
- 5 then you will understand the fear of the LORD and find the knowledge of God.
- 6 And here's why: GOD gives out Wisdom free, is plainspoken in Knowledge and Understanding.

- 6 For the LORD gives wisdom, and from his mouth come knowledge and understanding.
- 7 He's a rich mine of Common Sense for those who live well, a personal bodyguard to the candid and sincere.
- 7 He holds victory in store for the upright, he is a shield to those whose walk is blameless,
- 8 He keeps his eye on all who live honestly, and pays special attention to his loyally committed ones.
- 8 for he guards the course of the just and protects the way of his faithful ones.
- 9 So now you can pick out what's true and fair, find all the good trails!
- 9 Then you will understand what is right and just and fair--every good path.
- 10 Lady Wisdom will be your close friend, and Brother Knowledge your pleasant companion.
- 10 For wisdom will enter your heart, and knowledge will be pleasant to your soul.
- 11 Good Sense will scout ahead for danger, Insight will keep an eye out for you.
- 11 Discretion will protect you, and understanding will guard you.
- 12 They'll keep you from making wrong turns, or following the bad directions
- 12 Wisdom will save you from the ways of wicked men, from men whose words are perverse,
- 13 Of those who are lost themselves and can't tell a trail from a tumbleweed,
- 13 who leave the straight paths to walk in dark ways,
- 14 These losers who make a game of evil and throw parties to celebrate perversity,
- 14 who delight in doing wrong and rejoice in the perverseness of evil,
- 15 Traveling paths that go nowhere, wandering in a maze of detours and dead ends.
- 15 whose paths are crooked and who are devious in their ways.
- 16 Wise friends will rescue you from the Temptress-- that smooth-talking Seductress

- 16 It will save you also from the adulteress, from the wayward wife with her seductive words,
17 Who's faithless to the husband she married years ago, never gave a second thought to her promises before God.
17 who has left the partner of her youth and ignored the covenant she made before God.
18 Her whole way of life is doomed; every step she takes brings her closer to hell.
18 For her house leads down to death and her paths to the spirits of the dead.
19 No one who joins her company ever comes back, ever sets foot on the path to real living.
19 None who go to her return or attain the paths of life.
20 So--join the company of good men and women, keep your feet on the tried and true paths.
20 Thus you will walk in the ways of good men and keep to the paths of the righteous.
21 It's the men who walk straight who will settle this land, the women with integrity who will last here.
21 For the upright will live in the land, and the blameless will remain in it;
22 The corrupt will lose their lives; the dishonest will be gone for good.
22 but the wicked will be cut off from the land, and the unfaithful will be torn from it.

Proverbs 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Good friend, don't forget all I've taught you; take to heart my commands.
1 My son, do not forget my teaching, but keep my commands in your heart,
2 They'll help you live a long, long time, a long life lived full and well.
2 for they will prolong your life many years and bring you prosperity.
3 Don't lose your grip on Love and Loyalty. Tie them around your neck; carve their initials on your heart.
3 Let love and faithfulness never leave you; bind them around your neck, write them on the tablet of your heart.

4 Earn a reputation for living well in God's eyes and the eyes of the people.
4 Then you will win favor and a good name in the sight of God and man.
5 Trust GOD from the bottom of your heart; don't try to figure out everything on your own.
5 Trust in the LORD with all your heart and lean not on your own understanding;
6 Listen for GOD's voice in everything you do, everywhere you go; he's the one who will keep you on track.
6 in all your ways acknowledge him, and he will make your paths straight.
7 Don't assume that you know it all. Run to GOD! Run from evil!
7 Do not be wise in your own eyes; fear the LORD and shun evil.
8 Your body will glow with health, your very bones will vibrate with life!
8 This will bring health to your body and nourishment to your bones.
9 Honor GOD with everything you own; give him the first and the best.
9 Honor the LORD with your wealth, with the firstfruits of all your crops;
10 Your barns will burst, your wine vats will brim over.
10 then your barns will be filled to overflowing, and your vats will brim over with new wine.
11 But don't, dear friend, resent GOD's discipline; don't sulk under his loving correction.
11 My son, do not despise the LORD's discipline and do not resent his rebuke,
12 It's the child he loves that GOD corrects; a father's delight is behind all this.
12 because the LORD disciplines those he loves, as a father the son he delights in.
13 You're blessed when you meet Lady Wisdom, when you make friends with Madame Insight.
13 Blessed is the man who finds wisdom, the man who gains understanding,
14 She's worth far more than money in the bank; her friendship is better than a big salary.
14 for she is more profitable than silver and yields better returns than gold.
15 Her value exceeds all the trappings of wealth; nothing you could wish for holds a candle to her.

15 She is more precious than rubies; nothing you desire can compare with her.

16 With one hand she gives long life, with the other she confers recognition.

16 Long life is in her right hand; in her left hand are riches and honor.

17 Her manner is beautiful, her life wonderfully complete.

17 Her ways are pleasant ways, and all her paths are peace.

18 She's the very Tree of Life to those who embrace her. Hold her tight--and be blessed!

18 She is a tree of life to those who embrace her; those who lay hold of her will be blessed.

19 With Lady Wisdom, GOD formed Earth; with Madame Insight, he raised Heaven.

19 By wisdom the LORD laid the earth's foundations, by understanding he set the heavens in place;

20 They knew when to signal rivers and springs to the surface, and dew to descend from the night skies.

20 by his knowledge the deeps were divided, and the clouds let drop the dew.

21 Dear friend, guard Clear Thinking and Common Sense with your life; don't for a minute lose sight of them.

21 My son, preserve sound judgment and discernment, do not let them out of your sight;

22 They'll keep your soul alive and well, they'll keep you fit and attractive.

22 they will be life for you, an ornament to grace your neck.

23 You'll travel safely, you'll neither tire nor trip.

23 Then you will go on your way in safety, and your foot will not stumble;

24 You'll take afternoon naps without a worry, you'll enjoy a good night's sleep.

24 when you lie down, you will not be afraid; when you lie down, your sleep will be sweet.

25 No need to panic over alarms or surprises, or predictions that doomsday's just around the corner,

25 Have no fear of sudden disaster or of the ruin that overtakes the wicked,

26 Because GOD will be right there with you; he'll keep you safe and sound.

- 26 for the LORD will be your confidence and will keep your foot from being snared.
- 27 Never walk away from someone who deserves help; your hand is God's hand for that person.
- 27 Do not withhold good from those who deserve it, when it is in your power to act.
- 28 Don't tell your neighbor, "Maybe some other time," or, "Try me tomorrow," when the money's right there in your pocket.
- 28 Do not say to your neighbor, "Come back later; I'll give it tomorrow"--when you now have it with you.
- 29 Don't figure ways of taking advantage of your neighbor when he's sitting there trusting and unsuspecting.
- 29 Do not plot harm against your neighbor, who lives trustfully near you.
- 30 Don't walk around with a chip on your shoulder, always spoiling for a fight.
- 30 Do not accuse a man for no reason-- when he has done you no harm.
- 31 Don't try to be like those who shoulder their way through life. Why be a bully?
- 31 Do not envy a violent man or choose any of his ways,
- 32 "Why not?" you say. Because GOD can't stand twisted souls. It's the straightforward who get his respect.
- 32 for the LORD detests a perverse man but takes the upright into his confidence.
- 33 GOD's curse blights the house of the wicked, but he blesses the home of the righteous.
- 33 The LORD's curse is on the house of the wicked, but he blesses the home of the righteous.
- 34 He gives proud skeptics a cold shoulder, but if you're down on your luck, he's right there to help.
- 34 He mocks proud mockers but gives grace to the humble.
- 35 Wise living gets rewarded with honor; stupid living gets the booby prize.
- 35 The wise inherit honor, but fools he holds up to shame.

Proverbs 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 Listen, friends, to some fatherly advice; sit up and take notice so you'll know how to live.
- 1 Listen, my sons, to a father's instruction; pay attention and gain understanding.
- 2 I'm giving you good counsel; don't let it go in one ear and out the other.
- 2 I give you sound learning, so do not forsake my teaching.
- 3 When I was a boy at my father's knee, the pride and joy of my mother,
- 3 When I was a boy in my father's house, still tender, and an only child of my mother,
- 4 He would sit me down and drill me: "Take this to heart. Do what I tell you--live!
- 4 he taught me and said, "Lay hold of my words with all your heart; keep my commands and you will live.
- 5 Sell everything and buy Wisdom! Forage for Understanding! Don't forget one word! Don't deviate an inch!
- 5 Get wisdom, get understanding; do not forget my words or swerve from them.
- 6 Never walk away from Wisdom--she guards your life; love her--she keeps her eye on you.
- 6 Do not forsake wisdom, and she will protect you; love her, and she will watch over you.
- 7 Above all and before all, do this: Get Wisdom! Write this at the top of your list: Get Understanding!
- 7 Wisdom is supreme; therefore get wisdom. Though it cost all you have, get understanding.
- 8 Throw your arms around her--believe me, you won't regret it; never let her go--she'll make your life glorious.
- 8 Esteem her, and she will exalt you; embrace her, and she will honor you.
- 9 She'll garland your life with grace, she'll festoon your days with beauty."
- 9 She will set a garland of grace on your head and present you with a crown of splendor."
- 10 Dear friend, take my advice; it will add years to your life.
- 10 Listen, my son, accept what I say, and the years of your life will be many.

- 11 I'm writing out clear directions to Wisdom Way, I'm drawing a map to Righteous Road.
- 11 I guide you in the way of wisdom and lead you along straight paths.
- 12 I don't want you ending up in blind alleys, or wasting time making wrong turns.
- 12 When you walk, your steps will not be hampered; when you run, you will not stumble.
- 13 Hold tight to good advice; don't relax your grip. Guard it well--your life is at stake!
- 13 Hold on to instruction, do not let it go; guard it well, for it is your life.
- 14 Don't take Wicked Bypass; don't so much as set foot on that road.
- 14 Do not set foot on the path of the wicked or walk in the way of evil men.
- 15 Stay clear of it; give it a wide berth. Make a detour and be on your way.
- 15 Avoid it, do not travel on it; turn from it and go on your way.
- 16 Evil people are restless unless they're making trouble; They can't get a good night's sleep unless they've made life miserable for somebody.
- 16 For they cannot sleep till they do evil; they are robbed of slumber till they make someone fall.
- 17 Perversity is their food and drink, violence their drug of choice.
- 17 They eat the bread of wickedness and drink the wine of violence.
- 18 The ways of right-living people glow with light; the longer they live, the brighter they shine.
- 18 The path of the righteous is like the first gleam of dawn, shining ever brighter till the full light of day.
- 19 But the road of wrongdoing gets darker and darker-- travelers can't see a thing; they fall flat on their faces.
- 19 But the way of the wicked is like deep darkness; they do not know what makes them stumble.
- 20 Dear friend, listen well to my words; tune your ears to my voice.
- 20 My son, pay attention to what I say; listen closely to my words.
- 21 Keep my message in plain view at all times. Concentrate! Learn it by heart!
- 21 Do not let them out of your sight, keep them within your heart;
- 22 Those who discover these words live, really live; body and soul, they're bursting with health.

- 22 for they are life to those who find them and health to a man's whole body.
- 23 Keep vigilant watch over your heart; that's where life starts.
- 23 Above all else, guard your heart, for it is the wellspring of life.
- 24 Don't talk out of both sides of your mouth; avoid careless banter, white lies, and gossip.
- 24 Put away perversity from your mouth; keep corrupt talk far from your lips.
- 25 Keep your eyes straight ahead; ignore all sideshow distractions.
- 25 Let your eyes look straight ahead, fix your gaze directly before you.
- 26 Watch your step, and the road will stretch out smooth before you.
- 26 Make level paths for your feet and take only ways that are firm.
- 27 Look neither right nor left; leave evil in the dust.
- 27 Do not swerve to the right or the left; keep your foot from evil.

Proverbs 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 Dear friend, pay close attention to this, my wisdom; listen very closely to the way I see it.
- 1 My son, pay attention to my wisdom, listen well to my words of insight,
- 2 Then you'll acquire a taste for good sense; what I tell you will keep you out of trouble.
- 2 that you may maintain discretion and your lips may preserve knowledge.
- 3 The lips of a seductive woman are oh so sweet, her soft words are oh so smooth.
- 3 For the lips of an adulteress drip honey, and her speech is smoother than oil;
- 4 But it won't be long before she's gravel in your mouth, a pain in your gut, a wound in your heart.
- 4 but in the end she is bitter as gall, sharp as a double-edged sword.
- 5 She's dancing down the primrose path to Death; she's headed straight for Hell and taking you with her.
- 5 Her feet go down to death; her steps lead straight to the grave.
- 6 She hasn't a clue about Real Life, about who she is or where she's going.

- 6 She gives no thought to the way of life; her paths are crooked, but she knows it not.
- 7 So, my friend, listen closely; don't treat my words casually.
- 7 Now then, my sons, listen to me; do not turn aside from what I say.
- 8 Keep your distance from such a woman; absolutely stay out of her neighborhood.
- 8 Keep to a path far from her, do not go near the door of her house,
- 9 You don't want to squander your wonderful life, to waste your precious life among the hardhearted.
- 9 lest you give your best strength to others and your years to one who is cruel,
- 10 Why should you allow strangers to take advantage of you? Why be exploited by those who care nothing for you?
- 10 lest strangers feast on your wealth and your toil enrich another man's house.
- 11 You don't want to end your life full of regrets, nothing but sin and bones,
- 11 At the end of your life you will groan, when your flesh and body are spent.
- 12 Saying, "Oh, why didn't I do what they told me? Why did I reject a disciplined life?
- 12 You will say, "How I hated discipline! How my heart spurned correction!
- 13 Why didn't I listen to my mentors, or take my teachers seriously?
- 13 I would not obey my teachers or listen to my instructors.
- 14 My life is ruined! I haven't one blessed thing to show for my life!"
- 14 I have come to the brink of utter ruin in the midst of the whole assembly."
- 15 Do you know the saying, "Drink from your own rain barrel, draw water from your own spring-fed well"?
- 15 Drink water from your own cistern, running water from your own well.
- 16 It's true. Otherwise, you may one day come home and find your barrel empty and your well polluted.
- 16 Should your springs overflow in the streets, your streams of water in the public squares?

- 17 Your spring water is for you and you only, not to be passed around among strangers.
- 17 Let them be yours alone, never to be shared with strangers.
- 18 Bless your fresh-flowing fountain! Enjoy the wife you married as a young man!
- 18 May your fountain be blessed, and may you rejoice in the wife of your youth.
- 19 Lovely as an angel, beautiful as a rose-- don't ever quit taking delight in her body. Never take her love for granted!
- 19 A loving doe, a graceful deer-- may her breasts satisfy you always, may you ever be captivated by her love.
- 20 Why would you trade enduring intimacies for cheap thrills with a whore? for dalliance with a promiscuous stranger?
- 20 Why be captivated, my son, by an adulteress? Why embrace the bosom of another man's wife?
- 21 Mark well that GOD doesn't miss a move you make; he's aware of every step you take.
- 21 For a man's ways are in full view of the LORD, and he examines all his paths.
- 22 The shadow of your sin will overtake you; you'll find yourself stumbling all over yourself in the dark.
- 22 The evil deeds of a wicked man ensnare him; the cords of his sin hold him fast.
- 23 Death is the reward of an undisciplined life; your foolish decisions trap you in a dead end.
- 23 He will die for lack of discipline, led astray by his own great folly.

Proverbs 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Dear friend, if you've gone into hock with your neighbor or locked yourself into a deal with a stranger,
- 1 My son, if you have put up security for your neighbor, if you have struck hands in pledge for another,

- 2 If you've impulsively promised the shirt off your back and now find yourself shivering out in the cold,
- 2 if you have been trapped by what you said, ensnared by the words of your mouth,
- 3 Friend, don't waste a minute, get yourself out of that mess. You're in that man's clutches! Go, put on a long face; act desperate.
- 3 then do this, my son, to free yourself, since you have fallen into your neighbor's hands: Go and humble yourself; press your plea with your neighbor!
- 4 Don't procrastinate-- there's no time to lose.
- 4 Allow no sleep to your eyes, no slumber to your eyelids.
- 5 Run like a deer from the hunter, fly like a bird from the trapper!
- 5 Free yourself, like a gazelle from the hand of the hunter, like a bird from the snare of the fowler.
- 6 You lazy fool, look at an ant. Watch it closely; let it teach you a thing or two.
- 6 Go to the ant, you sluggard; consider its ways and be wise!
- 7 Nobody has to tell it what to do.
- 7 It has no commander, no overseer or ruler,
- 8 All summer it stores up food; at harvest it stockpiles provisions.
- 8 yet it stores its provisions in summer and gathers its food at harvest.
- 9 So how long are you going to laze around doing nothing? How long before you get out of bed?
- 9 How long will you lie there, you sluggard? When will you get up from your sleep?
- 10 A nap here, a nap there, a day off here, a day off there, sit back, take it easy--do you know what comes next?
- 10 A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to rest--
- 11 Just this: You can look forward to a dirt-poor life, poverty your permanent houseguest!
- 11 and poverty will come on you like a bandit and scarcity like an armed man.
- 12 Riffraff and rascals talk out of both sides of their mouths.
- 12 A scoundrel and villain, who goes about with a corrupt mouth,
- 13 They wink at each other, they shuffle their feet, they cross their fingers behind their backs.

13 who winks with his eye, signals with his feet and motions with his fingers,
14 Their perverse minds are always cooking up something nasty, always stirring up trouble.
14 who plots evil with deceit in his heart-- he always stirs up dissension.
15 Catastrophe is just around the corner for them, a total smash-up, their lives ruined beyond repair.
15 Therefore disaster will overtake him in an instant; he will suddenly be destroyed--without remedy.
16 Here are six things GOD hates, and one more that he loathes with a passion:
16 There are six things the LORD hates, seven that are detestable to him:
17 eyes that are arrogant, a tongue that lies, hands that murder the innocent,
17 haughty eyes, a lying tongue, hands that shed innocent blood,
18 a heart that hatches evil plots, feet that race down a wicked track,
18 a heart that devises wicked schemes, feet that are quick to rush into evil,
19 a mouth that lies under oath, a troublemaker in the family.
19 a false witness who pours out lies and a man who stirs up dissension among brothers.
20 Good friend, follow your father's good advice; don't wander off from your mother's teachings.
20 My son, keep your father's commands and do not forsake your mother's teaching.
21 Wrap yourself in them from head to foot; wear them like a scarf around your neck.
21 Bind them upon your heart forever; fasten them around your neck.
22 Wherever you walk, they'll guide you; whenever you rest, they'll guard you; when you wake up, they'll tell you what's next.
22 When you walk, they will guide you; when you sleep, they will watch over you; when you awake, they will speak to you.
23 For sound advice is a beacon, good teaching is a light, moral discipline is a life path.
23 For these commands are a lamp, this teaching is a light, and the corrections of discipline are the way to life,
24 They'll protect you from wanton women, from the seductive talk of some temptress.

24 keeping you from the immoral woman, from the smooth tongue of the wayward wife.

25 Don't lustfully fantasize on her beauty, nor be taken in by her bedroom eyes.

25 Do not lust in your heart after her beauty or let her captivate you with her eyes,

26 You can buy an hour with a whore for a loaf of bread, but a wanton woman may well eat you alive.

26 for the prostitute reduces you to a loaf of bread, and the adulteress preys upon your very life.

27 Can you build a fire in your lap and not burn your pants?

27 Can a man scoop fire into his lap without his clothes being burned?

28 Can you walk barefoot on hot coals and not get blisters?

28 Can a man walk on hot coals without his feet being scorched?

29 It's the same when you have sex with your neighbor's wife: Touch her and you'll pay for it. No excuses.

29 So is he who sleeps with another man's wife; no one who touches her will go unpunished.

30 Hunger is no excuse for a thief to steal;

30 Men do not despise a thief if he steals to satisfy his hunger when he is starving.

31 When he's caught he has to pay it back, even if he has to put his whole house in hock.

31 Yet if he is caught, he must pay sevenfold, though it costs him all the wealth of his house.

32 Adultery is a brainless act, soul-destroying, self-destructive;

32 But a man who commits adultery lacks judgment; whoever does so destroys himself.

33 Expect a bloody nose, a black eye, and a reputation ruined for good.

33 Blows and disgrace are his lot, and his shame will never be wiped away;

34 For jealousy detonates rage in a cheated husband; wild for revenge, he won't make allowances.

34 for jealousy arouses a husband's fury, and he will show no mercy when he takes revenge.

35 Nothing you say or pay will make it all right; neither bribes nor reason will satisfy him.

35 He will not accept any compensation; he will refuse the bribe, however great it is.

Proverbs 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Dear friend, do what I tell you; treasure my careful instructions.
- 1 My son, keep my words and store up my commands within you.
- 2 Do what I say and you'll live well. My teaching is as precious as your eyesight--guard it!
- 2 Keep my commands and you will live; guard my teachings as the apple of your eye.
- 3 Write it out on the back of your hands; etch it on the chambers of your heart.
- 3 Bind them on your fingers; write them on the tablet of your heart.
- 4 Talk to Wisdom as to a sister. Treat Insight as your companion.
- 4 Say to wisdom, "You are my sister," and call understanding your kinsman;
- 5 They'll be with you to fend off the Temptress-- that smooth-talking, honey-tongued Seductress.
- 5 they will keep you from the adulteress, from the wayward wife with her seductive words.
- 6 As I stood at the window of my house looking out through the shutters,
- 6 At the window of my house I looked out through the lattice.
- 7 Watching the mindless crowd stroll by, I spotted a young man without any sense
- 7 I saw among the simple, I noticed among the young men, a youth who lacked judgment.
- 8 Arriving at the corner of the street where she lived, then turning up the path to her house.
- 8 He was going down the street near her corner, walking along in the direction of her house
- 9 It was dusk, the evening coming on, the darkness thickening into night.
- 9 at twilight, as the day was fading, as the dark of night set in.

10 Just then, a woman met him-- she'd been lying in wait for him, dressed to seduce him.

10 Then out came a woman to meet him, dressed like a prostitute and with crafty intent.

11 Brazen and brash she was, restless and roaming, never at home,

11 (She is loud and defiant, her feet never stay at home;

12 Walking the streets, loitering in the mall, hanging out at every corner in town.

12 now in the street, now in the squares, at every corner she lurks.)

13 She threw her arms around him and kissed him, boldly took his arm and said,

13 She took hold of him and kissed him and with a brazen face she said:

14 "I've got all the makings for a feast-- today I made my offerings, my vows are all paid,

14 I have fellowship offerings at home; today I fulfilled my vows.

15 So now I've come to find you, hoping to catch sight of your face--and here you are!

15 So I came out to meet you; I looked for you and have found you!

16 I've spread fresh, clean sheets on my bed, colorful imported linens.

16 I have covered my bed with colored linens from Egypt.

17 My bed is aromatic with spices and exotic fragrances.

17 I have perfumed my bed with myrrh, aloes and cinnamon.

18 Come, let's make love all night, spend the night in ecstatic lovemaking!

18 Come, let's drink deep of love till morning; let's enjoy ourselves with love!

19 My husband's not home; he's away on business, and he won't be back for a month."

19 My husband is not at home; he has gone on a long journey.

20 (SEE 7:19)

20 He took his purse filled with money and will not be home till full moon."

21 Soon she has him eating out of her hand, bewitched by her honeyed speech.

21 With persuasive words she led him astray; she seduced him with her smooth talk.

22 Before you know it, he's trotting behind her, like a calf led to the
 butcher shop, Like a stag lured into ambush
 22 All at once he followed her like an ox going to the slaughter, like a deer
 stepping into a noose
 23 and then shot with an arrow, Like a bird flying into a net not knowing
 that its flying life is over.
 23 till an arrow pierces his liver, like a bird darting into a snare, little
 knowing it will cost him his life.
 24 So, friends, listen to me, take these words of mine most seriously.
 24 Now then, my sons, listen to me; pay attention to what I say.
 25 Don't fool around with a woman like that; don't even stroll through her
 neighborhood.
 25 Do not let your heart turn to her ways or stray into her paths.
 26 Countless victims come under her spell; she's the death of many a poor
 man.
 26 Many are the victims she has brought down; her slain are a mighty
 throng.
 27 She runs a halfway house to hell, fits you out with a shroud and a coffin.
 27 Her house is a highway to the grave, leading down to the chambers of
 death.

Proverbs 8

MSG

NIV

1 Do you hear Lady Wisdom calling? Can you hear Madame Insight
 raising her voice?
 1 Does not wisdom call out? Does not understanding raise her voice?
 2 She's taken her stand at First and Main, at the busiest intersection.
 2 On the heights along the way, where the paths meet, she takes her stand;
 3 Right in the city square where the traffic is thickest, she shouts,
 3 beside the gates leading into the city, at the entrances, she cries aloud:
 4 "You--I'm talking to all of you, everyone out here on the streets!
 4 To you, O men, I call out; I raise my voice to all mankind.
 5 Listen, you idiots--learn good sense! You blockheads--shape up!

- 5 You who are simple, gain prudence; you who are foolish, gain understanding.
- 6 Don't miss a word of this--I'm telling you how to live well, I'm telling you how to live at your best.
- 6 Listen, for I have worthy things to say; I open my lips to speak what is right.
- 7 My mouth chews and savors and relishes truth-- I can't stand the taste of evil!
- 7 My mouth speaks what is true, for my lips detest wickedness.
- 8 You'll only hear true and right words from my mouth; not one syllable will be twisted or skewed.
- 8 All the words of my mouth are just; none of them is crooked or perverse.
- 9 You'll recognize this as true--you with open minds; truth-ready minds will see it at once.
- 9 To the discerning all of them are right; they are faultless to those who have knowledge.
- 10 Prefer my life-disciplines over chasing after money, and God-knowledge over a lucrative career.
- 10 Choose my instruction instead of silver, knowledge rather than choice gold,
- 11 For Wisdom is better than all the trappings of wealth; nothing you could wish for holds a candle to her.
- 11 for wisdom is more precious than rubies, and nothing you desire can compare with her.
- 12 "I am Lady Wisdom, and I live next to Sanity; Knowledge and Discretion live just down the street.
- 12 I, wisdom, dwell together with prudence; I possess knowledge and discretion.
- 13 The Fear-of-GOD means hating Evil, whose ways I hate with a passion-- pride and arrogance and crooked talk.
- 13 To fear the LORD is to hate evil; I hate pride and arrogance, evil behavior and perverse speech.
- 14 Good counsel and common sense are my characteristics; I am both Insight and the Virtue to live it out.
- 14 Counsel and sound judgment are mine; I have understanding and power.
- 15 With my help, leaders rule, and lawmakers legislate fairly;

15 By me kings reign and rulers make laws that are just;
16 With my help, governors govern, along with all in legitimate authority.
16 by me princes govern, and all nobles who rule on earth.
17 I love those who love me; those who look for me find me.
17 I love those who love me, and those who seek me find me.
18 Wealth and Glory accompany me-- also substantial Honor and a Good Name.
18 With me are riches and honor, enduring wealth and prosperity.
19 My benefits are worth more than a big salary, even a very big salary; the returns on me exceed any imaginable bonus.
19 My fruit is better than fine gold; what I yield surpasses choice silver.
20 You can find me on Righteous Road--that's where I walk-- at the intersection of Justice Avenue,
20 I walk in the way of righteousness, along the paths of justice,
21 Handing out life to those who love me, filling their arms with life-- armloads of life!
21 bestowing wealth on those who love me and making their treasuries full.
22 "GOD sovereignly made me--the first, the basic-- before he did anything else.
22 The LORD brought me forth as the first of his works, before his deeds of old;
23 I was brought into being a long time ago, well before Earth got its start.
23 I was appointed from eternity, from the beginning, before the world began.
24 I arrived on the scene before Ocean, yes, even before Springs and Rivers and Lakes.
24 When there were no oceans, I was given birth, when there were no springs abounding with water;
25 Before Mountains were sculpted and Hills took shape, I was already there, newborn;
25 before the mountains were settled in place, before the hills, I was given birth,
26 Long before GOD stretched out Earth's Horizons, and tended to the minute details of Soil and Weather,
26 before he made the earth or its fields or any of the dust of the world.

27 And set Sky firmly in place, I was there. When he mapped and gave
borders to wild Ocean,
27 I was there when he set the heavens in place, when he marked out the
horizon on the face of the deep,
28 built the vast vault of Heaven, and installed the fountains that fed
Ocean,
28 when he established the clouds above and fixed securely the fountains
of the deep,
29 When he drew a boundary for Sea, posted a sign that said, NO
TRESPASSING, And then staked out Earth's foundations,
29 when he gave the sea its boundary so the waters would not overstep his
command, and when he marked out the foundations of the earth.
30 I was right there with him, making sure everything fit. Day after day I
was there, with my joyful applause, always enjoying his company,
30 Then I was the craftsman at his side. I was filled with delight day after
day, rejoicing always in his presence,
31 Delighted with the world of things and creatures, happily celebrating the
human family.
31 rejoicing in his whole world and delighting in mankind.
32 "So, my dear friends, listen carefully; those who embrace these my
ways are most blessed.
32 Now then, my sons, listen to me; blessed are those who keep my ways.
33 Mark a life of discipline and live wisely; don't squander your precious
life.
33 Listen to my instruction and be wise; do not ignore it.
34 Blessed the man, blessed the woman, who listens to me, awake and
ready for me each morning, alert and responsive as I start my day's work.
34 Blessed is the man who listens to me, watching daily at my doors,
waiting at my doorway.
35 When you find me, you find life, real life, to say nothing of GOD's good
pleasure.
35 For whoever finds me finds life and receives favor from the LORD.
36 But if you wrong me, you damage your very soul; when you reject me,
you're flirting with death."
36 But whoever fails to find me harms himself; all who hate me love
death."

Proverbs 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 Lady Wisdom has built and furnished her home; it's supported by seven hewn timbers.
- 1 Wisdom has built her house; she has hewn out its seven pillars.
- 2 The banquet meal is ready to be served: lamb roasted, wine poured out, table set with silver and flowers.
- 2 She has prepared her meat and mixed her wine; she has also set her table.
- 3 Having dismissed her serving maids, Lady Wisdom goes to town, stands in a prominent place, and invites everyone within sound of her voice:
- 3 She has sent out her maids, and she calls from the highest point of the city.
- 4 "Are you confused about life, don't know what's going on? Come with me, oh come, have dinner with me!
- 4 Let all who are simple come in here! she says to those who lack judgment.
- 5 I've prepared a wonderful spread--fresh-baked bread, roast lamb, carefully selected wines.
- 5 Come, eat my food and drink the wine I have mixed.
- 6 Leave your impoverished confusion and live! Walk up the street to a life with meaning."
- 6 Leave your simple ways and you will live; walk in the way of understanding.
- 7 If you reason with an arrogant cynic, you'll get slapped in the face; confront bad behavior and get a kick in the shins.
- 7 Whoever corrects a mocker invites insult; whoever rebukes a wicked man incurs abuse.
- 8 So don't waste your time on a scoffer; all you'll get for your pains is abuse. But if you correct those who care about life, that's different--they'll love you for it!
- 8 Do not rebuke a mocker or he will hate you; rebuke a wise man and he will love you.
- 9 Save your breath for the wise--they'll be wiser for it; tell good people what you know--they'll profit from it.

- 9 Instruct a wise man and he will be wiser still; teach a righteous man and he will add to his learning.
- 10 Skilled living gets its start in the Fear-of-GOD, insight into life from knowing a Holy God.
- 10 The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom, and knowledge of the Holy One is understanding.
- 11 It's through me, Lady Wisdom, that your life deepens, and the years of your life ripen.
- 11 For through me your days will be many, and years will be added to your life.
- 12 Live wisely and wisdom will permeate your life; mock life and life will mock you. Madame Whore Calls Out, Too
- 12 If you are wise, your wisdom will reward you; if you are a mocker, you alone will suffer."
- 13 Then there's this other woman, Madame Whore-- brazen, empty-headed, frivolous.
- 13 The woman Folly is loud; she is undisciplined and without knowledge.
- 14 She sits on the front porch of her house on Main Street,
- 14 She sits at the door of her house, on a seat at the highest point of the city,
- 15 And as people walk by minding their own business, calls out,
- 15 calling out to those who pass by, who go straight on their way.
- 16 "Are you confused about life, don't know what's going on?
- 16 Let all who are simple come in here! she says to those who lack judgment.
- 17 Steal off with me, I'll show you a good time! No one will ever know--I'll give you the time of your life."
- 17 Stolen water is sweet; food eaten in secret is delicious!
- 18 But they don't know about all the skeletons in her closet, that all her guests end up in hell.
- 18 But little do they know that the dead are there, that her guests are in the depths of the grave.

Proverbs 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 Wise son, glad father; stupid son, sad mother.
- 1 The proverbs of Solomon: A wise son brings joy to his father, but a foolish son grief to his mother.
- 2 Ill-gotten gain gets you nowhere; an honest life is immortal.
- 2 Ill-gotten treasures are of no value, but righteousness delivers from death.
- 3 GOD won't starve an honest soul, but he frustrates the appetites of the wicked.
- 3 The LORD does not let the righteous go hungry but he thwarts the craving of the wicked.
- 4 Sloth makes you poor; diligence brings wealth.
- 4 Lazy hands make a man poor, but diligent hands bring wealth.
- 5 Make hay while the sun shines--that's smart; go fishing during harvest--that's stupid.
- 5 He who gathers crops in summer is a wise son, but he who sleeps during harvest is a disgraceful son.
- 6 Blessings accrue on a good and honest life, but the mouth of the wicked is a dark cave of abuse.
- 6 Blessings crown the head of the righteous, but violence overwhelms the mouth of the wicked.
- 7 A good and honest life is a blessed memorial; a wicked life leaves a rotten stench.
- 7 The memory of the righteous will be a blessing, but the name of the wicked will rot.
- 8 A wise heart takes orders; an empty head will come unglued.
- 8 The wise in heart accept commands, but a chattering fool comes to ruin.
- 9 Honesty lives confident and carefree, but Shifty is sure to be exposed.
- 9 The man of integrity walks securely, but he who takes crooked paths will be found out.
- 10 An evasive eye is a sign of trouble ahead, but an open, face-to-face meeting results in peace.
- 10 He who winks maliciously causes grief, and a chattering fool comes to ruin.
- 11 The mouth of a good person is a deep, life-giving well, but the mouth of the wicked is a dark cave of abuse.

- 11 The mouth of the righteous is a fountain of life, but violence overwhelms the mouth of the wicked.
- 12 Hatred starts fights, but love pulls a quilt over the bickering.
- 12 Hatred stirs up dissension, but love covers over all wrongs.
- 13 You'll find wisdom on the lips of a person of insight, but the shortsighted needs a slap in the face.
- 13 Wisdom is found on the lips of the discerning, but a rod is for the back of him who lacks judgment.
- 14 The wise accumulate knowledge--a true treasure; know-it-alls talk too much--a sheer waste.
- 14 Wise men store up knowledge, but the mouth of a fool invites ruin.
- 15 The wealth of the rich is their bastion; the poverty of the indigent is their ruin.
- 15 The wealth of the rich is their fortified city, but poverty is the ruin of the poor.
- 16 The wage of a good person is exuberant life; an evil person ends up with nothing but sin.
- 16 The wages of the righteous bring them life, but the income of the wicked brings them punishment.
- 17 The road to life is a disciplined life; ignore correction and you're lost for good.
- 17 He who heeds discipline shows the way to life, but whoever ignores correction leads others astray.
- 18 Liars secretly hoard hatred; fools openly spread slander.
- 18 He who conceals his hatred has lying lips, and whoever spreads slander is a fool.
- 19 The more talk, the less truth; the wise measure their words.
- 19 When words are many, sin is not absent, but he who holds his tongue is wise.
- 20 The speech of a good person is worth waiting for; the blabber of the wicked is worthless.
- 20 The tongue of the righteous is choice silver, but the heart of the wicked is of little value.
- 21 The talk of a good person is rich fare for many, but chatterboxes die of an empty heart.

- 21 The lips of the righteous nourish many, but fools die for lack of judgment.
- 22 GOD's blessing makes life rich; nothing we do can improve on God.
- 22 The blessing of the LORD brings wealth, and he adds no trouble to it.
- 23 An empty-head thinks mischief is fun, but a mindful person relishes wisdom.
- 23 A fool finds pleasure in evil conduct, but a man of understanding delights in wisdom.
- 24 The nightmares of the wicked come true; what the good people desire, they get.
- 24 What the wicked dreads will overtake him; what the righteous desire will be granted.
- 25 When the storm is over, there's nothing left of the wicked; good people, firm on their rock foundation, aren't even fazed.
- 25 When the storm has swept by, the wicked are gone, but the righteous stand firm forever.
- 26 A lazy employee will give you nothing but trouble; it's vinegar in the mouth, smoke in the eyes.
- 26 As vinegar to the teeth and smoke to the eyes, so is a sluggard to those who send him.
- 27 The Fear-of-GOD expands your life; a wicked life is a puny life.
- 27 The fear of the LORD adds length to life, but the years of the wicked are cut short.
- 28 The aspirations of good people end in celebration; the ambitions of bad people crash.
- 28 The prospect of the righteous is joy, but the hopes of the wicked come to nothing.
- 29 GOD is solid backing to a well-lived life, but he calls into question a shabby performance.
- 29 The way of the LORD is a refuge for the righteous, but it is the ruin of those who do evil.
- 30 Good people last--they can't be moved; the wicked are here today, gone tomorrow.
- 30 The righteous will never be uprooted, but the wicked will not remain in the land.

- 31 A good person's mouth is a clear fountain of wisdom; a foul mouth is a stagnant swamp.
- 31 The mouth of the righteous brings forth wisdom, but a perverse tongue will be cut out.
- 32 The speech of a good person clears the air; the words of the wicked pollute it.
- 32 The lips of the righteous know what is fitting, but the mouth of the wicked only what is perverse.

Proverbs 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD hates cheating in the marketplace; he loves it when business is aboveboard.
- 1 The LORD abhors dishonest scales, but accurate weights are his delight.
- 2 The stuck-up fall flat on their faces, but down-to-earth people stand firm.
- 2 When pride comes, then comes disgrace, but with humility comes wisdom.
- 3 The integrity of the honest keeps them on track; the deviousness of crooks brings them to ruin.
- 3 The integrity of the upright guides them, but the unfaithful are destroyed by their duplicity.
- 4 A thick bankroll is no help when life falls apart, but a principled life can stand up to the worst.
- 4 Wealth is worthless in the day of wrath, but righteousness delivers from death.
- 5 Moral character makes for smooth traveling; an evil life is a hard life.
- 5 The righteousness of the blameless makes a straight way for them, but the wicked are brought down by their own wickedness.
- 6 Good character is the best insurance; crooks get trapped in their sinful lust.
- 6 The righteousness of the upright delivers them, but the unfaithful are trapped by evil desires.
- 7 When the wicked die, that's it-- the story's over, end of hope.

- 7 When a wicked man dies, his hope perishes; all he expected from his power comes to nothing.
- 8 A good person is saved from much trouble; a bad person runs straight into it.
- 8 The righteous man is rescued from trouble, and it comes on the wicked instead.
- 9 The loose tongue of the godless spreads destruction; the common sense of the godly preserves them.
- 9 With his mouth the godless destroys his neighbor, but through knowledge the righteous escape.
- 10 When it goes well for good people, the whole town cheers; when it goes badly for bad people, the town celebrates.
- 10 When the righteous prosper, the city rejoices; when the wicked perish, there are shouts of joy.
- 11 When right-living people bless the city, it flourishes; evil talk turns it into a ghost town in no time.
- 11 Through the blessing of the upright a city is exalted, but by the mouth of the wicked it is destroyed.
- 12 Mean-spirited slander is heartless; quiet discretion accompanies good sense.
- 12 A man who lacks judgment derides his neighbor, but a man of understanding holds his tongue.
- 13 A gadabout gossip can't be trusted with a secret, but someone of integrity won't violate a confidence.
- 13 A gossip betrays a confidence, but a trustworthy man keeps a secret.
- 14 Without good direction, people lose their way; the more wise counsel you follow, the better your chances.
- 14 For lack of guidance a nation falls, but many advisers make victory sure.
- 15 Whoever makes deals with strangers is sure to get burned; if you keep a cool head, you'll avoid rash bargains.
- 15 He who puts up security for another will surely suffer, but whoever refuses to strike hands in pledge is safe.
- 16 A woman of gentle grace gets respect, but men of rough violence grab for loot.
- 16 A kindhearted woman gains respect, but ruthless men gain only wealth.

- 17 When you're kind to others, you help yourself; when you're cruel to others, you hurt yourself.
- 17 A kind man benefits himself, but a cruel man brings trouble on himself.
- 18 Bad work gets paid with a bad check; good work gets solid pay.
- 18 The wicked man earns deceptive wages, but he who sows righteousness reaps a sure reward.
- 19 Take your stand with God's loyal community and live, or chase after phantoms of evil and die.
- 19 The truly righteous man attains life, but he who pursues evil goes to his death.
- 20 GOD can't stand deceivers, but oh how he relishes integrity.
- 20 The LORD detests men of perverse heart but he delights in those whose ways are blameless.
- 21 Count on this: The wicked won't get off scot-free, and God's loyal people will triumph.
- 21 Be sure of this: The wicked will not go unpunished, but those who are righteous will go free.
- 22 Like a gold ring in a pig's snout is a beautiful face on an empty head.
- 22 Like a gold ring in a pig's snout is a beautiful woman who shows no discretion.
- 23 The desires of good people lead straight to the best, but wicked ambition ends in angry frustration.
- 23 The desire of the righteous ends only in good, but the hope of the wicked only in wrath.
- 24 The world of the generous gets larger and larger; the world of the stingy gets smaller and smaller.
- 24 One man gives freely, yet gains even more; another withholds unduly, but comes to poverty.
- 25 The one who blesses others is abundantly blessed; those who help others are helped.
- 25 A generous man will prosper; he who refreshes others will himself be refreshed.
- 26 Curses on those who drive a hard bargain! Blessings on all who play fair and square!
- 26 People curse the man who hoards grain, but blessing crowns him who is willing to sell.

- 27 The one who seeks good finds delight; the student of evil becomes evil.
27 He who seeks good finds goodwill, but evil comes to him who searches for it.
28 A life devoted to things is a dead life, a stump; a God-shaped life is a flourishing tree.
28 Whoever trusts in his riches will fall, but the righteous will thrive like a green leaf.
29 Exploit or abuse your family, and end up with a fistful of air; common sense tells you it's a stupid way to live.
29 He who brings trouble on his family will inherit only wind, and the fool will be servant to the wise.
30 A good life is a fruit-bearing tree; a violent life destroys souls.
30 The fruit of the righteous is a tree of life, and he who wins souls is wise.
31 If good people barely make it, what's in store for the bad!
31 If the righteous receive their due on earth, how much more the ungodly and the sinner!

Proverbs 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 If you love learning, you love the discipline that goes with it-- how shortsighted to refuse correction!
1 Whoever loves discipline loves knowledge, but he who hates correction is stupid.
2 A good person basks in the delight of GOD, and he wants nothing to do with devious schemers.
2 A good man obtains favor from the LORD, but the LORD condemns a crafty man.
3 You can't find firm footing in a swamp, but life rooted in God stands firm.
3 A man cannot be established through wickedness, but the righteous cannot be uprooted.
4 A hearty wife invigorates her husband, but a frigid woman is cancer in the bones.

- 4 A wife of noble character is her husband's crown, but a disgraceful wife is like decay in his bones.
- 5 The thinking of principled people makes for justice; the plots of degenerates corrupt.
- 5 The plans of the righteous are just, but the advice of the wicked is deceitful.
- 6 The words of the wicked kill; the speech of the upright saves.
- 6 The words of the wicked lie in wait for blood, but the speech of the upright rescues them.
- 7 Wicked people fall to pieces--there's nothing to them; the homes of good people hold together.
- 7 Wicked men are overthrown and are no more, but the house of the righteous stands firm.
- 8 A person who talks sense is honored; airheads are held in contempt.
- 8 A man is praised according to his wisdom, but men with warped minds are despised.
- 9 Better to be ordinary and work for a living than act important and starve in the process.
- 9 Better to be a nobody and yet have a servant than pretend to be somebody and have no food.
- 10 Good people are good to their animals; the "good-hearted" bad people kick and abuse them.
- 10 A righteous man cares for the needs of his animal, but the kindest acts of the wicked are cruel.
- 11 The one who stays on the job has food on the table; the witless chase whims and fancies.
- 11 He who works his land will have abundant food, but he who chases fantasies lacks judgment.
- 12 What the wicked construct finally falls into ruin, while the roots of the righteous give life, and more life.
- 12 The wicked desire the plunder of evil men, but the root of the righteous flourishes.
- 13 The gossip of bad people gets them in trouble; the conversation of good people keeps them out of it.
- 13 An evil man is trapped by his sinful talk, but a righteous man escapes trouble.

- 14 Well-spoken words bring satisfaction; well-done work has its own reward.
- 14 From the fruit of his lips a man is filled with good things as surely as the work of his hands rewards him.
- 15 Fools are headstrong and do what they like; wise people take advice.
- 15 The way of a fool seems right to him, but a wise man listens to advice.
- 16 Fools have short fuses and explode all too quickly; the prudent quietly shrug off insults.
- 16 A fool shows his annoyance at once, but a prudent man overlooks an insult.
- 17 Truthful witness by a good person clears the air, but liars lay down a smoke screen of deceit.
- 17 A truthful witness gives honest testimony, but a false witness tells lies.
- 18 Rash language cuts and maims, but there is healing in the words of the wise.
- 18 Reckless words pierce like a sword, but the tongue of the wise brings healing.
- 19 Truth lasts; lies are here today, gone tomorrow.
- 19 Truthful lips endure forever, but a lying tongue lasts only a moment.
- 20 Evil scheming distorts the schemer; peace-planning brings joy to the planner.
- 20 There is deceit in the hearts of those who plot evil, but joy for those who promote peace.
- 21 No evil can overwhelm a good person, but the wicked have their hands full of it.
- 21 No harm befalls the righteous, but the wicked have their fill of trouble.
- 22 God can't stomach liars; he loves the company of those who keep their word.
- 22 The LORD detests lying lips, but he delights in men who are truthful.
- 23 Prudent people don't flaunt their knowledge; talkative fools broadcast their silliness.
- 23 A prudent man keeps his knowledge to himself, but the heart of fools blurts out folly.
- 24 The diligent find freedom in their work; the lazy are oppressed by work.
- 24 Diligent hands will rule, but laziness ends in slave labor.
- 25 Worry weighs us down; a cheerful word picks us up.

- 25 An anxious heart weighs a man down, but a kind word cheers him up.
26 A good person survives misfortune, but a wicked life invites disaster.
26 A righteous man is cautious in friendship, but the way of the wicked leads them astray.
27 A lazy life is an empty life, but "early to rise" gets the job done.
27 The lazy man does not roast his game, but the diligent man prizes his possessions.
28 Good men and women travel right into life; sin's detours take you straight to hell.
28 In the way of righteousness there is life; along that path is immortality.

Proverbs 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 Intelligent children listen to their parents; foolish children do their own thing.
1 A wise son heeds his father's instruction, but a mocker does not listen to rebuke.
2 The good acquire a taste for helpful conversation; bullies push and shove their way through life.
2 From the fruit of his lips a man enjoys good things, but the unfaithful have a craving for violence.
3 Careful words make for a careful life; careless talk may ruin everything.
3 He who guards his lips guards his life, but he who speaks rashly will come to ruin.
4 Indolence wants it all and gets nothing; the energetic have something to show for their lives.
4 The sluggard craves and gets nothing, but the desires of the diligent are fully satisfied.
5 A good person hates false talk; a bad person wallows in gibberish.
5 The righteous hate what is false, but the wicked bring shame and disgrace.
6 A God-loyal life keeps you on track; sin dumps the wicked in the ditch.
6 Righteousness guards the man of integrity, but wickedness overthrows the sinner.

- 7 A pretentious, showy life is an empty life; a plain and simple life is a full life.
- 7 One man pretends to be rich, yet has nothing; another pretends to be poor, yet has great wealth.
- 8 The rich can be sued for everything they have, but the poor are free of such threats.
- 8 A man's riches may ransom his life, but a poor man hears no threat.
- 9 The lives of good people are brightly lit streets; the lives of the wicked are dark alleys.
- 9 The light of the righteous shines brightly, but the lamp of the wicked is snuffed out.
- 10 Arrogant know-it-alls stir up discord, but wise men and women listen to each other's counsel.
- 10 Pride only breeds quarrels, but wisdom is found in those who take advice.
- 11 Easy come, easy go, but steady diligence pays off.
- 11 Dishonest money dwindles away, but he who gathers money little by little makes it grow.
- 12 Unrelenting disappointment leaves you heartsick, but a sudden good break can turn life around.
- 12 Hope deferred makes the heart sick, but a longing fulfilled is a tree of life.
- 13 Ignore the Word and suffer; honor God's commands and grow rich.
- 13 He who scorns instruction will pay for it, but he who respects a command is rewarded.
- 14 The teaching of the wise is a fountain of life, so, no more drinking from death-tainted wells!
- 14 The teaching of the wise is a fountain of life, turning a man from the snares of death.
- 15 Sound thinking makes for gracious living, but liars walk a rough road.
- 15 Good understanding wins favor, but the way of the unfaithful is hard.
- 16 A commonsense person lives good sense; fools litter the country with silliness.
- 16 Every prudent man acts out of knowledge, but a fool exposes his folly.
- 17 Irresponsible talk makes a real mess of things, but a reliable reporter is a healing presence.

- 17 A wicked messenger falls into trouble, but a trustworthy envoy brings healing.
- 18 Refuse discipline and end up homeless; embrace correction and live an honored life.
- 18 He who ignores discipline comes to poverty and shame, but whoever heeds correction is honored.
- 19 Souls who follow their hearts thrive; fools bent on evil despise matters of soul.
- 19 A longing fulfilled is sweet to the soul, but fools detest turning from evil.
- 20 Become wise by walking with the wise; hang out with fools and watch your life fall to pieces.
- 20 He who walks with the wise grows wise, but a companion of fools suffers harm.
- 21 Disaster entraps sinners, but God-loyal people get a good life.
- 21 Misfortune pursues the sinner, but prosperity is the reward of the righteous.
- 22 A good life gets passed on to the grandchildren; ill-gotten wealth ends up with good people.
- 22 A good man leaves an inheritance for his children's children, but a sinner's wealth is stored up for the righteous.
- 23 Banks foreclose on the farms of the poor, or else the poor lose their shirts to crooked lawyers.
- 23 A poor man's field may produce abundant food, but injustice sweeps it away.
- 24 A refusal to correct is a refusal to love; love your children by disciplining them.
- 24 He who spares the rod hates his son, but he who loves him is careful to discipline him.
- 25 An appetite for good brings much satisfaction, but the belly of the wicked always wants more.
- 25 The righteous eat to their hearts' content, but the stomach of the wicked goes hungry.

Proverbs 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 Lady Wisdom builds a lovely home; Sir Fool comes along and tears it down brick by brick.
- 1 The wise woman builds her house, but with her own hands the foolish one tears hers down.
- 2 An honest life shows respect for GOD; a degenerate life is a slap in his face.
- 2 He whose walk is upright fears the LORD, but he whose ways are devious despises him.
- 3 Frivolous talk provokes a derisive smile; wise speech evokes nothing but respect.
- 3 A fool's talk brings a rod to his back, but the lips of the wise protect them.
- 4 No cattle, no crops; a good harvest requires a strong ox for the plow.
- 4 Where there are no oxen, the manger is empty, but from the strength of an ox comes an abundant harvest.
- 5 A true witness never lies; a false witness makes a business of it.
- 5 A truthful witness does not deceive, but a false witness pours out lies.
- 6 Cynics look high and low for wisdom--and never find it; the open-minded find it right on their doorstep!
- 6 The mocker seeks wisdom and finds none, but knowledge comes easily to the discerning.
- 7 Escape quickly from the company of fools; they're a waste of your time, a waste of your words.
- 7 Stay away from a foolish man, for you will not find knowledge on his lips.
- 8 The wisdom of the wise keeps life on track; the foolishness of fools lands them in the ditch.
- 8 The wisdom of the prudent is to give thought to their ways, but the folly of fools is deception.
- 9 The stupid ridicule right and wrong, but a moral life is a favored life.
- 9 Fools mock at making amends for sin, but goodwill is found among the upright.
- 10 The person who shuns the bitter moments of friends will be an outsider at their celebrations.

- 10 Each heart knows its own bitterness, and no one else can share its joy.
- 11 Lives of careless wrongdoing are tumbledown shacks; holy living builds soaring cathedrals.
- 11 The house of the wicked will be destroyed, but the tent of the upright will flourish.
- 12 There's a way of life that looks harmless enough; look again--it leads straight to hell.
- 12 There is a way that seems right to a man, but in the end it leads to death.
- 13 Sure, those people appear to be having a good time, but all that laughter will end in heartbreak.
- 13 Even in laughter the heart may ache, and joy may end in grief.
- 14 A mean person gets paid back in meanness, a gracious person in grace.
- 14 The faithless will be fully repaid for their ways, and the good man rewarded for his.
- 15 The gullible believe anything they're told; the prudent sift and weigh every word.
- 15 A simple man believes anything, but a prudent man gives thought to his steps.
- 16 The wise watch their steps and avoid evil; fools are headstrong and reckless.
- 16 A wise man fears the LORD and shuns evil, but a fool is hotheaded and reckless.
- 17 The hotheaded do things they'll later regret; the coldhearted get the cold shoulder.
- 17 A quick-tempered man does foolish things, and a crafty man is hated.
- 18 Foolish dreamers live in a world of illusion; wise realists plant their feet on the ground.
- 18 The simple inherit folly, but the prudent are crowned with knowledge.
- 19 Eventually, evil will pay tribute to good; the wicked will respect God-loyal people.
- 19 Evil men will bow down in the presence of the good, and the wicked at the gates of the righteous.
- 20 An unlucky loser is shunned by all, but everyone loves a winner.
- 20 The poor are shunned even by their neighbors, but the rich have many friends.

- 21 It's criminal to ignore a neighbor in need, but compassion for the poor--
what a blessing!
- 21 He who despises his neighbor sins, but blessed is he who is kind to the
needy.
- 22 Isn't it obvious that conspirators lose out, while the thoughtful win love
and trust?
- 22 Do not those who plot evil go astray? But those who plan what is good
find love and faithfulness.
- 23 Hard work always pays off; mere talk puts no bread on the table.
- 23 All hard work brings a profit, but mere talk leads only to poverty.
- 24 The wise accumulate wisdom; fools get stupider by the day.
- 24 The wealth of the wise is their crown, but the folly of fools yields folly.
- 25 Souls are saved by truthful witness and betrayed by the spread of lies.
- 25 A truthful witness saves lives, but a false witness is deceitful.
- 26 The Fear-of-GOD builds up confidence, and makes a world safe for
your children.
- 26 He who fears the LORD has a secure fortress, and for his children it will
be a refuge.
- 27 The Fear-of-GOD is a spring of living water so you won't go off
drinking from poisoned wells.
- 27 The fear of the LORD is a fountain of life, turning a man from the
snares of death.
- 28 The mark of a good leader is loyal followers; leadership is nothing
without a following.
- 28 A large population is a king's glory, but without subjects a prince is
ruined.
- 29 Slowness to anger makes for deep understanding; a quick-tempered
person stockpiles stupidity.
- 29 A patient man has great understanding, but a quick-tempered man
displays folly.
- 30 A sound mind makes for a robust body, but runaway emotions corrode
the bones.
- 30 A heart at peace gives life to the body, but envy rots the bones.
- 31 You insult your Maker when you exploit the powerless; when you're
kind to the poor, you honor God.

- 31 He who oppresses the poor shows contempt for their Maker, but whoever is kind to the needy honors God.
- 32 The evil of bad people leaves them out in the cold; the integrity of good people creates a safe place for living.
- 32 When calamity comes, the wicked are brought down, but even in death the righteous have a refuge.
- 33 Lady Wisdom is at home in an understanding heart-- fools never even get to say hello.
- 33 Wisdom reposes in the heart of the discerning and even among fools she lets herself be known.
- 34 God-devotion makes a country strong; God-avoidance leaves people weak.
- 34 Righteousness exalts a nation, but sin is a disgrace to any people.
- 35 Diligent work gets a warm commendation; shiftless work earns an angry rebuke.
- 35 A king delights in a wise servant, but a shameful servant incurs his wrath.

Proverbs 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 A gentle response defuses anger, but a sharp tongue kindles a temper-fire.
- 1 A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.
- 2 Knowledge flows like spring water from the wise; fools are leaky faucets, dripping nonsense.
- 2 The tongue of the wise commends knowledge, but the mouth of the fool gushes folly.
- 3 GOD doesn't miss a thing-- he's alert to good and evil alike.
- 3 The eyes of the LORD are everywhere, keeping watch on the wicked and the good.
- 4 Kind words heal and help; cutting words wound and maim.
- 4 The tongue that brings healing is a tree of life, but a deceitful tongue crushes the spirit.
- 5 Moral dropouts won't listen to their elders; welcoming correction is a mark of good sense.

- 5 A fool spurns his father's discipline, but whoever heeds correction shows prudence.
- 6 The lives of God-loyal people flourish; a misspent life is soon bankrupt.
- 6 The house of the righteous contains great treasure, but the income of the wicked brings them trouble.
- 7 Perceptive words spread knowledge; fools are hollow--there's nothing to them.
- 7 The lips of the wise spread knowledge; not so the hearts of fools.
- 8 GOD can't stand pious poses, but he delights in genuine prayers.
- 8 The LORD detests the sacrifice of the wicked, but the prayer of the upright pleases him.
- 9 A life frittered away disgusts GOD; he loves those who run straight for the finish line.
- 9 The LORD detests the way of the wicked but he loves those who pursue righteousness.
- 10 It's a school of hard knocks for those who leave God's path, a dead-end street for those who hate God's rules.
- 10 Stern discipline awaits him who leaves the path; he who hates correction will die.
- 11 Even hell holds no secrets from GOD-- do you think he can't read human hearts?
- 11 Death and Destruction lie open before the LORD-- how much more the hearts of men!
- 12 Know-it-alls don't like being told what to do; they avoid the company of wise men and women.
- 12 A mocker resents correction; he will not consult the wise.
- 13 A cheerful heart brings a smile to your face; a sad heart makes it hard to get through the day.
- 13 A happy heart makes the face cheerful, but heartache crushes the spirit.
- 14 An intelligent person is always eager to take in more truth; fools feed on fast-food fads and fancies.
- 14 The discerning heart seeks knowledge, but the mouth of a fool feeds on folly.
- 15 A miserable heart means a miserable life; a cheerful heart fills the day with song.

- 15 All the days of the oppressed are wretched, but the cheerful heart has a continual feast.
- 16 A simple life in the Fear-of-GOD is better than a rich life with a ton of headaches.
- 16 Better a little with the fear of the LORD than great wealth with turmoil.
- 17 Better a bread crust shared in love than a slab of prime rib served in hate.
- 17 Better a meal of vegetables where there is love than a fattened calf with hatred.
- 18 Hot tempers start fights; a calm, cool spirit keeps the peace.
- 18 A hot-tempered man stirs up dissension, but a patient man calms a quarrel.
- 19 The path of lazy people is overgrown with briars; the diligent walk down a smooth road.
- 19 The way of the sluggard is blocked with thorns, but the path of the upright is a highway.
- 20 Intelligent children make their parents proud; lazy students embarrass their parents.
- 20 A wise son brings joy to his father, but a foolish man despises his mother.
- 21 The empty-headed treat life as a plaything; the perceptive grasp its meaning and make a go of it.
- 21 Folly delights a man who lacks judgment, but a man of understanding keeps a straight course.
- 22 Refuse good advice and watch your plans fail; take good counsel and watch them succeed.
- 22 Plans fail for lack of counsel, but with many advisers they succeed.
- 23 Congenial conversation--what a pleasure! The right word at the right time--beautiful!
- 23 A man finds joy in giving an apt reply-- and how good is a timely word!
- 24 Life ascends to the heights for the thoughtful-- it's a clean about-face from descent into hell.
- 24 The path of life leads upward for the wise to keep him from going down to the grave.
- 25 GOD smashes the pretensions of the arrogant; he stands with those who have no standing.

- 25 The LORD tears down the proud man's house but he keeps the widow's boundaries intact.
- 26 GOD can't stand evil scheming, but he puts words of grace and beauty on display.
- 26 The LORD detests the thoughts of the wicked, but those of the pure are pleasing to him.
- 27 A greedy and grasping person destroys community; those who refuse to exploit live and let live.
- 27 A greedy man brings trouble to his family, but he who hates bribes will live.
- 28 Prayerful answers come from God-loyal people; the wicked are sewers of abuse.
- 28 The heart of the righteous weighs its answers, but the mouth of the wicked gushes evil.
- 29 GOD keeps his distance from the wicked; he closely attends to the prayers of God-loyal people.
- 29 The LORD is far from the wicked but he hears the prayer of the righteous.
- 30 A twinkle in the eye means joy in the heart, and good news makes you feel fit as a fiddle.
- 30 A cheerful look brings joy to the heart, and good news gives health to the bones.
- 31 Listen to good advice if you want to live well, an honored guest among wise men and women.
- 31 He who listens to a life-giving rebuke will be at home among the wise.
- 32 An undisciplined, self-willed life is puny; an obedient, God-willed life is spacious.
- 32 He who ignores discipline despises himself, but whoever heeds correction gains understanding.
- 33 Fear-of-GOD is a school in skilled living-- first you learn humility, then you experience glory.
- 33 The fear of the LORD teaches a man wisdom, and humility comes before honor.

Proverbs 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 Mortals make elaborate plans, but GOD has the last word.
- 1 To man belong the plans of the heart, but from the LORD comes the reply of the tongue.
- 2 Humans are satisfied with whatever looks good; GOD probes for what is good.
- 2 All a man's ways seem innocent to him, but motives are weighed by the LORD.
- 3 Put GOD in charge of your work, then what you've planned will take place.
- 3 Commit to the LORD whatever you do, and your plans will succeed.
- 4 GOD made everything with a place and purpose; even the wicked are included--but for judgment.
- 4 The LORD works out everything for his own ends-- even the wicked for a day of disaster.
- 5 GOD can't stomach arrogance or pretense; believe me, he'll put those upstarts in their place.
- 5 The LORD detests all the proud of heart. Be sure of this: They will not go unpunished.
- 6 Guilt is banished through love and truth; Fear-of-GOD deflects evil.
- 6 Through love and faithfulness sin is atoned for; through the fear of the LORD a man avoids evil.
- 7 When GOD approves of your life, even your enemies will end up shaking your hand.
- 7 When a man's ways are pleasing to the LORD, he makes even his enemies live at peace with him.
- 8 Far better to be right and poor than to be wrong and rich.
- 8 Better a little with righteousness than much gain with injustice.
- 9 We plan the way we want to live, but only GOD makes us able to live it.
- 9 In his heart a man plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps.
- 10 A good leader motivates, doesn't mislead, doesn't exploit.
- 10 The lips of a king speak as an oracle, and his mouth should not betray justice.
- 11 GOD cares about honesty in the workplace; your business is his business.

- 11 Honest scales and balances are from the LORD; all the weights in the bag are of his making.
- 12 Good leaders abhor wrongdoing of all kinds; sound leadership has a moral foundation.
- 12 Kings detest wrongdoing, for a throne is established through righteousness.
- 13 Good leaders cultivate honest speech; they love advisors who tell them the truth.
- 13 Kings take pleasure in honest lips; they value a man who speaks the truth.
- 14 An intemperate leader wreaks havoc in lives; you're smart to stay clear of someone like that.
- 14 A king's wrath is a messenger of death, but a wise man will appease it.
- 15 Good-tempered leaders invigorate lives; they're like spring rain and sunshine.
- 15 When a king's face brightens, it means life; his favor is like a rain cloud in spring.
- 16 Get wisdom--it's worth more than money; choose insight over income every time.
- 16 How much better to get wisdom than gold, to choose understanding rather than silver!
- 17 The road of right living bypasses evil; watch your step and save your life.
- 17 The highway of the upright avoids evil; he who guards his way guards his life.
- 18 First pride, then the crash-- the bigger the ego, the harder the fall.
- 18 Pride goes before destruction, a haughty spirit before a fall.
- 19 It's better to live humbly among the poor than to live it up among the rich and famous.
- 19 Better to be lowly in spirit and among the oppressed than to share plunder with the proud.
- 20 It pays to take life seriously; things work out when you trust in GOD.
- 20 Whoever gives heed to instruction prospers, and blessed is he who trusts in the LORD.
- 21 A wise person gets known for insight; gracious words add to one's reputation.

- 21 The wise in heart are called discerning, and pleasant words promote instruction.
- 22 True intelligence is a spring of fresh water, while fools sweat it out the hard way.
- 22 Understanding is a fountain of life to those who have it, but folly brings punishment to fools.
- 23 They make a lot of sense, these wise folks; whenever they speak, their reputation increases.
- 23 A wise man's heart guides his mouth, and his lips promote instruction.
- 24 Gracious speech is like clover honey-- good taste to the soul, quick energy for the body.
- 24 Pleasant words are a honeycomb, sweet to the soul and healing to the bones.
- 25 There's a way that looks harmless enough; look again--it leads straight to hell.
- 25 There is a way that seems right to a man, but in the end it leads to death.
- 26 Appetite is an incentive to work; hunger makes you work all the harder.
- 26 The laborer's appetite works for him; his hunger drives him on.
- 27 Mean people spread mean gossip; their words smart and burn.
- 27 A scoundrel plots evil, and his speech is like a scorching fire.
- 28 Troublemakers start fights; gossips break up friendships.
- 28 A perverse man stirs up dissension, and a gossip separates close friends.
- 29 Calloused climbers betray their very own friends; they'd stab their own grandmothers in the back.
- 29 A violent man entices his neighbor and leads him down a path that is not good.
- 30 A shifty eye betrays an evil intention; a clenched jaw signals trouble ahead.
- 30 He who winks with his eye is plotting perversity; he who purses his lips is bent on evil.
- 31 Gray hair is a mark of distinction, the award for a God-loyal life.
- 31 Gray hair is a crown of splendor; it is attained by a righteous life.
- 32 Moderation is better than muscle, self-control better than political power.
- 32 Better a patient man than a warrior, a man who controls his temper than one who takes a city.

33 Make your motions and cast your votes, but GOD has the final say.
33 The lot is cast into the lap, but its every decision is from the LORD.

Proverbs 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 A meal of bread and water in contented peace is better than a banquet spiced with quarrels.
- 1 Better a dry crust with peace and quiet than a house full of feasting, with strife.
- 2 A wise servant takes charge of an unruly child and is honored as one of the family.
- 2 A wise servant will rule over a disgraceful son, and will share the inheritance as one of the brothers.
- 3 As silver in a crucible and gold in a pan, so our lives are assayed by GOD.
- 3 The crucible for silver and the furnace for gold, but the LORD tests the heart.
- 4 Evil people relish malicious conversation; the ears of liars itch for dirty gossip.
- 4 A wicked man listens to evil lips; a liar pays attention to a malicious tongue.
- 5 Whoever mocks poor people, insults their Creator; gloating over misfortune is a punishable crime.
- 5 He who mocks the poor shows contempt for their Maker; whoever gloats over disaster will not go unpunished.
- 6 Old people are distinguished by grandchildren; children take pride in their parents.
- 6 Children's children are a crown to the aged, and parents are the pride of their children.
- 7 We don't expect eloquence from fools, nor do we expect lies from our leaders.
- 7 Arrogant lips are unsuited to a fool-- how much worse lying lips to a ruler!

- 8 Receiving a gift is like getting a rare gemstone; any way you look at it, you see beauty refracted.
- 8 A bribe is a charm to the one who gives it; wherever he turns, he succeeds.
- 9 Overlook an offense and bond a friendship; fasten on to a slight and--good-bye, friend!
- 9 He who covers over an offense promotes love, but whoever repeats the matter separates close friends.
- 10 A quiet rebuke to a person of good sense does more than a whack on the head of a fool.
- 10 A rebuke impresses a man of discernment more than a hundred lashes a fool.
- 11 Criminals out looking for nothing but trouble won't have to wait long--they'll meet it coming and going!
- 11 An evil man is bent only on rebellion; a merciless official will be sent against him.
- 12 Better to meet a grizzly robbed of her cubs than a fool hellbent on folly.
- 12 Better to meet a bear robbed of her cubs than a fool in his folly.
- 13 Those who return evil for good will meet their own evil returning.
- 13 If a man pays back evil for good, evil will never leave his house.
- 14 The start of a quarrel is like a leak in a dam, so stop it before it bursts.
- 14 Starting a quarrel is like breaching a dam; so drop the matter before a dispute breaks out.
- 15 Whitewashing bad people and throwing mud on good people are equally abhorrent to GOD.
- 15 Acquitting the guilty and condemning the innocent-- the LORD detests them both.
- 16 What's this? Fools out shopping for wisdom! They wouldn't recognize it if they saw it!
- 16 Of what use is money in the hand of a fool, since he has no desire to get wisdom?
- 17 Friends love through all kinds of weather, and families stick together in all kinds of trouble.
- 17 A friend loves at all times, and a brother is born for adversity.
- 18 It's stupid to try to get something for nothing, or run up huge bills you can never pay.

- 18 A man lacking in judgment strikes hands in pledge and puts up security for his neighbor.
- 19 The person who courts sin, marries trouble; build a wall, invite a burglar.
- 19 He who loves a quarrel loves sin; he who builds a high gate invites destruction.
- 20 A bad motive can't achieve a good end; double-talk brings you double trouble.
- 20 A man of perverse heart does not prosper; he whose tongue is deceitful falls into trouble.
- 21 Having a fool for a child is misery; it's no fun being the parent of a dolt.
- 21 To have a fool for a son brings grief; there is no joy for the father of a fool.
- 22 A cheerful disposition is good for your health; gloom and doom leave you bone-tired.
- 22 A cheerful heart is good medicine, but a crushed spirit dries up the bones.
- 23 The wicked take bribes under the table; they show nothing but contempt for justice.
- 23 A wicked man accepts a bribe in secret to pervert the course of justice.
- 24 The perceptive find wisdom in their own front yard; fools look for it everywhere but right here.
- 24 A discerning man keeps wisdom in view, but a fool's eyes wander to the ends of the earth.
- 25 A surly, stupid child is sheer pain to a father, a bitter pill for a mother to swallow.
- 25 A foolish son brings grief to his father and bitterness to the one who bore him.
- 26 It's wrong to penalize good behavior, or make good citizens pay for the crimes of others.
- 26 It is not good to punish an innocent man, or to flog officials for their integrity.
- 27 The one who knows much says little; an understanding person remains calm.
- 27 A man of knowledge uses words with restraint, and a man of understanding is even-tempered.

28 Even dunces who keep quiet are thought to be wise; as long as they keep their mouths shut, they're smart.

28 Even a fool is thought wise if he keeps silent, and discerning if he holds his tongue.

Proverbs 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 Loners who care only for themselves spit on the common good.
- 1 An unfriendly man pursues selfish ends; he defies all sound judgment.
- 2 Fools care nothing for thoughtful discourse; all they do is run off at the mouth.
- 2 A fool finds no pleasure in understanding but delights in airing his own opinions.
- 3 When wickedness arrives, shame's not far behind; contempt for life is contemptible.
- 3 When wickedness comes, so does contempt, and with shame comes disgrace.
- 4 Many words rush along like rivers in flood, but deep wisdom flows up from artesian springs.
- 4 The words of a man's mouth are deep waters, but the fountain of wisdom is a bubbling brook.
- 5 It's not right to go easy on the guilty, or come down hard on the innocent.
- 5 It is not good to be partial to the wicked or to deprive the innocent of justice.
- 6 The words of a fool start fights; do him a favor and gag him.
- 6 A fool's lips bring him strife, and his mouth invites a beating.
- 7 Fools are undone by their big mouths; their souls are crushed by their words.
- 7 A fool's mouth is his undoing, and his lips are a snare to his soul.
- 8 Listening to gossip is like eating cheap candy; do you really want junk like that in your belly?
- 8 The words of a gossip are like choice morsels; they go down to a man's inmost parts.
- 9 Slack habits and sloppy work are as bad as vandalism.

- 9 One who is slack in his work is brother to one who destroys.
- 10 GOD's name is a place of protection-- good people can run there and be safe.
- 10 The name of the LORD is a strong tower; the righteous run to it and are safe.
- 11 The rich think their wealth protects them; they imagine themselves safe behind it.
- 11 The wealth of the rich is their fortified city; they imagine it an unscalable wall.
- 12 Pride first, then the crash, but humility is precursor to honor.
- 12 Before his downfall a man's heart is proud, but humility comes before honor.
- 13 Answering before listening is both stupid and rude.
- 13 He who answers before listening-- that is his folly and his shame.
- 14 A healthy spirit conquers adversity, but what can you do when the spirit is crushed?
- 14 A man's spirit sustains him in sickness, but a crushed spirit who can bear?
- 15 Wise men and women are always learning, always listening for fresh insights.
- 15 The heart of the discerning acquires knowledge; the ears of the wise seek it out.
- 16 A gift gets attention; it buys the attention of eminent people.
- 16 A gift opens the way for the giver and ushers him into the presence of the great.
- 17 The first speech in a court case is always convincing-- until the cross-examination starts!
- 17 The first to present his case seems right, till another comes forward and questions him.
- 18 You may have to draw straws when faced with a tough decision.
- 18 Casting the lot settles disputes and keeps strong opponents apart.
- 19 Do a favor and win a friend forever; nothing can untie that bond.
- 19 An offended brother is more unyielding than a fortified city, and disputes are like the barred gates of a citadel.
- 20 Words satisfy the mind as much as fruit does the stomach; good talk is as gratifying as a good harvest.

- 20 From the fruit of his mouth a man's stomach is filled; with the harvest from his lips he is satisfied.
- 21 Words kill, words give life; they're either poison or fruit--you choose.
- 21 The tongue has the power of life and death, and those who love it will eat its fruit.
- 22 Find a good spouse, you find a good life-- and even more: the favor of GOD!
- 22 He who finds a wife finds what is good and receives favor from the LORD.
- 23 The poor speak in soft supplications; the rich bark out answers.
- 23 A poor man pleads for mercy, but a rich man answers harshly.
- 24 Friends come and friends go, but a true friend sticks by you like family.
- 24 A man of many companions may come to ruin, but there is a friend who sticks closer than a brother.

Proverbs 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 Better to be poor and honest than a rich person no one can trust.
- 1 Better a poor man whose walk is blameless than a fool whose lips are perverse.
- 2 Ignorant zeal is worthless; haste makes waste.
- 2 It is not good to have zeal without knowledge, nor to be hasty and miss the way.
- 3 People ruin their lives by their own stupidity, so why does GOD always get blamed?
- 3 A man's own folly ruins his life, yet his heart rages against the LORD.
- 4 Wealth attracts friends as honey draws flies, but poor people are avoided like a plague.
- 4 Wealth brings many friends, but a poor man's friend deserts him.
- 5 Perjury won't go unpunished. Would you let a liar go free?
- 5 A false witness will not go unpunished, and he who pours out lies will not go free.
- 6 Lots of people flock around a generous person; everyone's a friend to the philanthropist.

- 6 Many curry favor with a ruler, and everyone is the friend of a man who gives gifts.
- 7 When you're down on your luck, even your family avoids you-- yes, even your best friends wish you'd get lost. If they see you coming, they look the other way-- out of sight, out of mind.
- 7 A poor man is shunned by all his relatives-- how much more do his friends avoid him! Though he pursues them with pleading, they are nowhere to be found.
- 8 Grow a wise heart--you'll do yourself a favor; keep a clear head--you'll find a good life.
- 8 He who gets wisdom loves his own soul; he who cherishes understanding prospers.
- 9 The person who tells lies gets caught; the person who spreads rumors is ruined.
- 9 A false witness will not go unpunished, and he who pours out lies will perish.
- 10 Blockheads shouldn't live on easy street any more than workers should give orders to their boss.
- 10 It is not fitting for a fool to live in luxury-- how much worse for a slave to rule over princes!
- 11 Smart people know how to hold their tongue; their grandeur is to forgive and forget.
- 11 A man's wisdom gives him patience; it is to his glory to overlook an offense.
- 12 Mean-tempered leaders are like mad dogs; the good-natured are like fresh morning dew.
- 12 A king's rage is like the roar of a lion, but his favor is like dew on the grass.
- 13 A parent is worn to a frazzle by a stupid child; a nagging spouse is a leaky faucet.
- 13 A foolish son is his father's ruin, and a quarrelsome wife is like a constant dripping.
- 14 House and land are handed down from parents, but a congenial spouse comes straight from GOD.
- 14 Houses and wealth are inherited from parents, but a prudent wife is from the LORD.

- 15 Life collapses on loafers; lazybones go hungry.
- 15 Laziness brings on deep sleep, and the shiftless man goes hungry.
- 16 Keep the rules and keep your life; careless living kills.
- 16 He who obeys instructions guards his life, but he who is contemptuous of his ways will die.
- 17 Mercy to the needy is a loan to GOD, and GOD pays back those loans in full.
- 17 He who is kind to the poor lends to the LORD, and he will reward him for what he has done.
- 18 Discipline your children while you still have the chance; indulging them destroys them.
- 18 Discipline your son, for in that there is hope; do not be a willing party to his death.
- 19 Let angry people endure the backlash of their own anger; if you try to make it better, you'll only make it worse.
- 19 A hot-tempered man must pay the penalty; if you rescue him, you will have to do it again.
- 20 Take good counsel and accept correction-- that's the way to live wisely and well.
- 20 Listen to advice and accept instruction, and in the end you will be wise.
- 21 We humans keep brainstorming options and plans, but GOD's purpose prevails.
- 21 Many are the plans in a man's heart, but it is the LORD's purpose that prevails.
- 22 It's only human to want to make a buck, but it's better to be poor than a liar.
- 22 What a man desires is unfailing love; better to be poor than a liar.
- 23 Fear-of-GOD is life itself, a full life, and serene--no nasty surprises.
- 23 The fear of the LORD leads to life: Then one rests content, untouched by trouble.
- 24 Some people dig a fork into the pie but are too lazy to raise it to their mouth.
- 24 The sluggard buries his hand in the dish; he will not even bring it back to his mouth!
- 25 Punish the insolent--make an example of them. Who knows? Somebody might learn a good lesson.

- 25 Flog a mocker, and the simple will learn prudence; rebuke a discerning man, and he will gain knowledge.
- 26 Kids who lash out against their parents are an embarrassment and disgrace.
- 26 He who robs his father and drives out his mother is a son who brings shame and disgrace.
- 27 If you quit listening, dear child, and strike off on your own, you'll soon be out of your depth.
- 27 Stop listening to instruction, my son, and you will stray from the words of knowledge.
- 28 An unprincipled witness desecrates justice; the mouths of the wicked spew malice.
- 28 A corrupt witness mocks at justice, and the mouth of the wicked gulps down evil.
- 29 The irreverent have to learn reverence the hard way; only a slap in the face brings fools to attention.
- 29 Penalties are prepared for mockers, and beatings for the backs of fools.

Proverbs 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 Wine makes you mean, beer makes you quarrelsome-- a staggering drunk is not much fun.
- 1 Wine is a mocker and beer a brawler; whoever is led astray by them is not wise.
- 2 Quick-tempered leaders are like mad dogs-- cross them and they bite your head off.
- 2 A king's wrath is like the roar of a lion; he who angers him forfeits his life.
- 3 It's a mark of good character to avert quarrels, but fools love to pick fights.
- 3 It is to a man's honor to avoid strife, but every fool is quick to quarrel.
- 4 A farmer too lazy to plant in the spring has nothing to harvest in the fall.
- 4 A sluggard does not plow in season; so at harvest time he looks but finds nothing.

- 5 Knowing what is right is like deep water in the heart; a wise person draws from the well within.
- 5 The purposes of a man's heart are deep waters, but a man of understanding draws them out.
- 6 Lots of people claim to be loyal and loving, but where on earth can you find one?
- 6 Many a man claims to have unfailing love, but a faithful man who can find?
- 7 God-loyal people, living honest lives, make it much easier for their children.
- 7 The righteous man leads a blameless life; blessed are his children after him.
- 8 Leaders who know their business and care keep a sharp eye out for the shoddy and cheap,
- 8 When a king sits on his throne to judge, he winnows out all evil with his eyes.
- 9 For who among us can be trusted to be always diligent and honest?
- 9 Who can say, "I have kept my heart pure; I am clean and without sin"?
- 10 Switching price tags and padding the expense account are two things GOD hates.
- 10 Differing weights and differing measures-- the LORD detests them both.
- 11 Young people eventually reveal by their actions if their motives are on the up and up.
- 11 Even a child is known by his actions, by whether his conduct is pure and right.
- 12 Ears that hear and eyes that see-- we get our basic equipment from GOD!
- 12 Ears that hear and eyes that see-- the LORD has made them both.
- 13 Don't be too fond of sleep; you'll end up in the poorhouse. Wake up and get up; then there'll be food on the table.
- 13 Do not love sleep or you will grow poor; stay awake and you will have food to spare.
- 14 The shopper says, "That's junk--I'll take it off your hands," then goes off boasting of the bargain.

- 14 It's no good, it's no good! says the buyer; then off he goes and boasts about his purchase.
- 15 Drinking from the beautiful chalice of knowledge is better than adorning oneself with gold and rare gems.
- 15 Gold there is, and rubies in abundance, but lips that speak knowledge are a rare jewel.
- 16 Hold tight to collateral on any loan to a stranger; beware of accepting what a transient has pawned.
- 16 Take the garment of one who puts up security for a stranger; hold it in pledge if he does it for a wayward woman.
- 17 Stolen bread tastes sweet, but soon your mouth is full of gravel.
- 17 Food gained by fraud tastes sweet to a man, but he ends up with a mouth full of gravel.
- 18 Form your purpose by asking for counsel, then carry it out using all the help you can get.
- 18 Make plans by seeking advice; if you wage war, obtain guidance.
- 19 Gossips can't keep secrets, so never confide in blabbermouths.
- 19 A gossip betrays a confidence; so avoid a man who talks too much.
- 20 Anyone who curses father and mother extinguishes light and exists benighted.
- 20 If a man curses his father or mother, his lamp will be snuffed out in pitch darkness.
- 21 A bonanza at the beginning is no guarantee of blessing at the end.
- 21 An inheritance quickly gained at the beginning will not be blessed at the end.
- 22 Don't ever say, "I'll get you for that!" Wait for GOD; he'll settle the score.
- 22 Do not say, "I'll pay you back for this wrong!" Wait for the LORD, and he will deliver you.
- 23 GOD hates cheating in the marketplace; rigged scales are an outrage.
- 23 The LORD detests differing weights, and dishonest scales do not please him.
- 24 The very steps we take come from GOD; otherwise how would we know where we're going?
- 24 A man's steps are directed by the LORD. How then can anyone understand his own way?

- 25 An impulsive vow is a trap; later you'll wish you could get out of it.
25 It is a trap for a man to dedicate something rashly and only later to consider his vows.
26 After careful scrutiny, a wise leader makes a clean sweep of rebels and dolts.
26 A wise king winnows out the wicked; he drives the threshing wheel over them.
27 GOD is in charge of human life, watching and examining us inside and out.
27 The lamp of the LORD searches the spirit of a man; it searches out his inmost being.
28 Love and truth form a good leader; sound leadership is founded on loving integrity.
28 Love and faithfulness keep a king safe; through love his throne is made secure.
29 Youth may be admired for vigor, but gray hair gives prestige to old age.
29 The glory of young men is their strength, gray hair the splendor of the old.
30 A good thrashing purges evil; punishment goes deep within us.
30 Blows and wounds cleanse away evil, and beatings purge the inmost being.

Proverbs 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 Good leadership is a channel of water controlled by God; he directs it to whatever ends he chooses.
1 The king's heart is in the hand of the LORD; he directs it like a watercourse wherever he pleases.
2 We justify our actions by appearances; GOD examines our motives.
2 All a man's ways seem right to him, but the LORD weighs the heart.
3 Clean living before God and justice with our neighbors mean far more to GOD than religious performance.
3 To do what is right and just is more acceptable to the LORD than sacrifice.

- 4 Arrogance and pride--distinguishing marks in the wicked-- are just plain sin.
- 4 Haughty eyes and a proud heart, the lamp of the wicked, are sin!
- 5 Careful planning puts you ahead in the long run; hurry and scurry puts you further behind.
- 5 The plans of the diligent lead to profit as surely as haste leads to poverty.
- 6 Make it to the top by lying and cheating; get paid with smoke and a promotion--to death!
- 6 A fortune made by a lying tongue is a fleeting vapor and a deadly snare.
- 7 The wicked get buried alive by their loot because they refuse to use it to help others.
- 7 The violence of the wicked will drag them away, for they refuse to do what is right.
- 8 Mixed motives twist life into tangles; pure motives take you straight down the road.
- 8 The way of the guilty is devious, but the conduct of the innocent is upright.
- 9 Better to live alone in a tumbledown shack than share a mansion with a nagging spouse.
- 9 Better to live on a corner of the roof than share a house with a quarrelsome wife.
- 10 Wicked souls love to make trouble; they feel nothing for friends and neighbors.
- 10 The wicked man craves evil; his neighbor gets no mercy from him.
- 11 Simpletons only learn the hard way, but the wise learn by listening.
- 11 When a mocker is punished, the simple gain wisdom; when a wise man is instructed, he gets knowledge.
- 12 A God-loyal person will see right through the wicked and undo the evil they've planned.
- 12 The Righteous One takes note of the house of the wicked and brings the wicked to ruin.
- 13 If you stop your ears to the cries of the poor, your cries will go unheard, unanswered.
- 13 If a man shuts his ears to the cry of the poor, he too will cry out and not be answered.

- 14 A quietly given gift soothes an irritable person; a heartfelt present cools a hot temper.
- 14 A gift given in secret soothes anger, and a bribe concealed in the cloak pacifies great wrath.
- 15 Good people celebrate when justice triumphs, but for the workers of evil it's a bad day.
- 15 When justice is done, it brings joy to the righteous but terror to evildoers.
- 16 Whoever wanders off the straight and narrow ends up in a congregation of ghosts.
- 16 A man who strays from the path of understanding comes to rest in the company of the dead.
- 17 You're addicted to thrills? What an empty life! The pursuit of pleasure is never satisfied.
- 17 He who loves pleasure will become poor; whoever loves wine and oil will never be rich.
- 18 What a bad person plots against the good, boomerangs; the plotter gets it in the end.
- 18 The wicked become a ransom for the righteous, and the unfaithful for the upright.
- 19 Better to live in a tent in the wild than with a cross and petulant spouse.
- 19 Better to live in a desert than with a quarrelsome and ill-tempered wife.
- 20 Valuables are safe in a wise person's home; fools put it all out for yard sales.
- 20 In the house of the wise are stores of choice food and oil, but a foolish man devours all he has.
- 21 Whoever goes hunting for what is right and kind finds life itself-- glorious life!
- 21 He who pursues righteousness and love finds life, prosperity and honor.
- 22 One sage entered a whole city of armed soldiers-- their trusted defenses fell to pieces!
- 22 A wise man attacks the city of the mighty and pulls down the stronghold in which they trust.
- 23 Watch your words and hold your tongue; you'll save yourself a lot of grief.
- 23 He who guards his mouth and his tongue keeps himself from calamity.

- 24 You know their names--Brash, Impudent, Blasphemer-- intemperate hotheads, every one.
- 24 The proud and arrogant man--"Mocker" is his name; he behaves with overweening pride.
- 25 Lazy people finally die of hunger because they won't get up and go to work.
- 25 The sluggard's craving will be the death of him, because his hands refuse to work.
- 26 Sinners are always wanting what they don't have; the God-loyal are always giving what they do have.
- 26 All day long he craves for more, but the righteous give without sparing.
- 27 Religious performance by the wicked stinks; it's even worse when they use it to get ahead.
- 27 The sacrifice of the wicked is detestable-- how much more so when brought with evil intent!
- 28 A lying witness is unconvincing; a person who speaks truth is respected.
- 28 A false witness will perish, and whoever listens to him will be destroyed forever.
- 29 Unscrupulous people fake it a lot; honest people are sure of their steps.
- 29 A wicked man puts up a bold front, but an upright man gives thought to his ways.
- 30 Nothing clever, nothing conceived, nothing contrived, can get the better of GOD.
- 30 There is no wisdom, no insight, no plan that can succeed against the LORD.
- 31 Do your best, prepare for the worst-- then trust GOD to bring victory.
- 31 The horse is made ready for the day of battle, but victory rests with the LORD.

Proverbs 22

MSG

NIV

- 1 A sterling reputation is better than striking it rich; a gracious spirit is better than money in the bank.

- 1 A good name is more desirable than great riches; to be esteemed is better than silver or gold.
- 2 The rich and the poor shake hands as equals-- GOD made them both!
- 2 Rich and poor have this in common: The LORD is the Maker of them all.
- 3 A prudent person sees trouble coming and ducks; a simpleton walks in blindly and is clobbered.
- 3 A prudent man sees danger and takes refuge, but the simple keep going and suffer for it.
- 4 The payoff for meekness and Fear-of-GOD is plenty and honor and a satisfying life.
- 4 Humility and the fear of the LORD bring wealth and honor and life.
- 5 The perverse travel a dangerous road, potholed and mud-slick; if you know what's good for you, stay clear of it.
- 5 In the paths of the wicked lie thorns and snares, but he who guards his soul stays far from them.
- 6 Point your kids in the right direction-- when they're old they won't be lost.
- 6 Train a child in the way he should go, and when he is old he will not turn from it.
- 7 The poor are always ruled over by the rich, so don't borrow and put yourself under their power.
- 7 The rich rule over the poor, and the borrower is servant to the lender.
- 8 Whoever sows sin reaps weeds, and bullying anger sputters into nothing.
- 8 He who sows wickedness reaps trouble, and the rod of his fury will be destroyed.
- 9 Generous hands are blessed hands because they give bread to the poor.
- 9 A generous man will himself be blessed, for he shares his food with the poor.
- 10 Kick out the troublemakers and things will quiet down; you need a break from bickering and griping!
- 10 Drive out the mocker, and out goes strife; quarrels and insults are ended.
- 11 GOD loves the pure-hearted and well-spoken; good leaders also delight in their friendship.
- 11 He who loves a pure heart and whose speech is gracious will have the king for his friend.

- 12 GOD guards knowledge with a passion, but he'll have nothing to do with deception.
- 12 The eyes of the LORD keep watch over knowledge, but he frustrates the words of the unfaithful.
- 13 The loafer says, "There's a lion on the loose! If I go out I'll be eaten alive!"
- 13 The sluggard says, "There is a lion outside!" or, "I will be murdered in the streets!"
- 14 The mouth of a whore is a bottomless pit; you'll fall in that pit if you're on the outs with GOD.
- 14 The mouth of an adulteress is a deep pit; he who is under the LORD's wrath will fall into it.
- 15 Young people are prone to foolishness and fads; the cure comes through tough-minded discipline.
- 15 Folly is bound up in the heart of a child, but the rod of discipline will drive it far from him.
- 16 Exploit the poor or glad-hand the rich--whichever, you'll end up the poorer for it.
- 16 He who oppresses the poor to increase his wealth and he who gives gifts to the rich--both come to poverty.
- 17 Listen carefully to my wisdom; take to heart what I can teach you. You'll treasure its sweetness deep within;
- 17 Pay attention and listen to the sayings of the wise; apply your heart to what I teach,
- 18 you'll give it bold expression in your speech.
- 18 for it is pleasing when you keep them in your heart and have all of them ready on your lips.
- 19 To make sure your foundation is trust in GOD, I'm laying it all out right now just for you.
- 19 So that your trust may be in the LORD, I teach you today, even you.
- 20 I'm giving you thirty sterling principles-- tested guidelines to live by.
- 20 Have I not written thirty sayings for you, sayings of counsel and knowledge,
- 21 Believe me--these are truths that work, and will keep you accountable to those who sent you.

- 21 teaching you true and reliable words, so that you can give sound answers to him who sent you?
- 22 Don't walk on the poor just because they're poor, and don't use your position to crush the weak,
- 22 Do not exploit the poor because they are poor and do not crush the needy in court,
- 23 Because GOD will come to their defense; the life you took, he'll take from you and give back to them.
- 23 for the LORD will take up their case and will plunder those who plunder them.
- 24 Don't hang out with angry people; don't keep company with hotheads.
- 24 Do not make friends with a hot-tempered man, do not associate with one easily angered,
- 25 Bad temper is contagious-- don't get infected.
- 25 or you may learn his ways and get yourself ensnared.
- 26 Don't gamble on the pot of gold at the end of the rainbow, hocking your house against a lucky chance.
- 26 Do not be a man who strikes hands in pledge or puts up security for debts;
- 27 The time will come when you have to pay up; you'll be left with nothing but the shirt on your back.
- 27 if you lack the means to pay, your very bed will be snatched from under you.
- 28 Don't stealthily move back the boundary lines staked out long ago by your ancestors.
- 28 Do not move an ancient boundary stone set up by your forefathers.
- 29 Observe people who are good at their work-- skilled workers are always in demand and admired; they don't take a back seat to anyone.
- 29 Do you see a man skilled in his work? He will serve before kings; he will not serve before obscure men.

Proverbs 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 When you go out to dinner with an influential person, mind your manners:
- 1 When you sit to dine with a ruler, note well what is before you,
- 2 Don't gobble your food, don't talk with your mouth full.
- 2 and put a knife to your throat if you are given to gluttony.
- 3 And don't stuff yourself; bridle your appetite.
- 3 Do not crave his delicacies, for that food is deceptive.
- 4 Don't wear yourself out trying to get rich; restrain yourself!
- 4 Do not wear yourself out to get rich; have the wisdom to show restraint.
- 5 Riches disappear in the blink of an eye; wealth sprouts wings and flies off into the wild blue yonder.
- 5 Cast but a glance at riches, and they are gone, for they will surely sprout wings and fly off to the sky like an eagle.
- 6 Don't accept a meal from a tightwad; don't expect anything special.
- 6 Do not eat the food of a stingy man, do not crave his delicacies;
- 7 He'll be as stingy with you as he is with himself; he'll say, "Eat! Drink!" but won't mean a word of it.
- 7 for he is the kind of man who is always thinking about the cost. "Eat and drink," he says to you, but his heart is not with you.
- 8 His miserly serving will turn your stomach when you realize the meal's a sham.
- 8 You will vomit up the little you have eaten and will have wasted your compliments.
- 9 Don't bother talking sense to fools; they'll only poke fun at your words.
- 9 Do not speak to a fool, for he will scorn the wisdom of your words.
- 10 Don't stealthily move back the boundary lines or cheat orphans out of their property,
- 10 Do not move an ancient boundary stone or encroach on the fields of the fatherless,
- 11 For they have a powerful Advocate who will go to bat for them.
- 11 for their Defender is strong; he will take up their case against you.
- 12 Give yourselves to disciplined instruction; open your ears to tested knowledge.
- 12 Apply your heart to instruction and your ears to words of knowledge.
- 13 Don't be afraid to correct your young ones; a spanking won't kill them.

- 13 Do not withhold discipline from a child; if you punish him with the rod, he will not die.
- 14 A good spanking, in fact, might save them from something worse than death.
- 14 Punish him with the rod and save his soul from death.
- 15 Dear child, if you become wise, I'll be one happy parent.
- 15 My son, if your heart is wise, then my heart will be glad;
- 16 My heart will dance and sing to the tuneful truth you'll speak.
- 16 my inmost being will rejoice when your lips speak what is right.
- 17 Don't for a minute envy careless rebels; soak yourself in the Fear-of-GOD--
- 17 Do not let your heart envy sinners, but always be zealous for the fear of the LORD.
- 18 That's where your future lies. Then you won't be left with an armload of nothing.
- 18 There is surely a future hope for you, and your hope will not be cut off.
- 19 Oh listen, dear child--become wise; point your life in the right direction.
- 19 Listen, my son, and be wise, and keep your heart on the right path.
- 20 Don't drink too much wine and get drunk; don't eat too much food and get fat.
- 20 Do not join those who drink too much wine or gorge themselves on meat,
- 21 Drunks and gluttons will end up on skid row, in a stupor and dressed in rags.
- 21 for drunkards and gluttons become poor, and drowsiness clothes them in rags.
- 22 Listen with respect to the father who raised you, and when your mother grows old, don't neglect her.
- 22 Listen to your father, who gave you life, and do not despise your mother when she is old.
- 23 Buy truth--don't sell it for love or money; buy wisdom, buy education, buy insight.
- 23 Buy the truth and do not sell it; get wisdom, discipline and understanding.
- 24 Parents rejoice when their children turn out well; wise children become proud parents.

24 The father of a righteous man has great joy; he who has a wise son
delights in him.

25 So make your father happy! Make your mother proud!

25 May your father and mother be glad; may she who gave you birth
rejoice!

26 Dear child, I want your full attention; please do what I show you.

26 My son, give me your heart and let your eyes keep to my ways,

27 A whore is a bottomless pit; a loose woman can get you in deep trouble
fast.

27 for a prostitute is a deep pit and a wayward wife is a narrow well.

28 She'll take you for all you've got; she's worse than a pack of thieves.

28 Like a bandit she lies in wait, and multiplies the unfaithful among men.

29 Who are the people who are always crying the blues? Who do you know
who reeks of self-pity? Who keeps getting beat up for no reason at all?
Whose eyes are bleary and bloodshot?

29 Who has woe? Who has sorrow? Who has strife? Who has complaints?
Who has needless bruises? Who has bloodshot eyes?

30 It's those who spend the night with a bottle, for whom drinking is
serious business.

30 Those who linger over wine, who go to sample bowls of mixed wine.

31 Don't judge wine by its label, or its bouquet, or its full-bodied flavor.

31 Do not gaze at wine when it is red, when it sparkles in the cup, when it
goes down smoothly!

32 Judge it rather by the hangover it leaves you with-- the splitting
headache, the queasy stomach.

32 In the end it bites like a snake and poisons like a viper.

33 Do you really prefer seeing double, with your speech all slurred,

33 Your eyes will see strange sights and your mind imagine confusing
things.

34 Reeling and seasick, drunk as a sailor?

34 You will be like one sleeping on the high seas, lying on top of the
rigging.

35 "They hit me," you'll say, "but it didn't hurt; they beat on me, but I didn't
feel a thing. When I'm sober enough to manage it, bring me another
drink!"

35 They hit me, you will say, "but I'm not hurt! They beat me, but I don't feel it! When will I wake up so I can find another drink?"

Proverbs 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 Don't envy bad people; don't even want to be around them.
- 1 Do not envy wicked men, do not desire their company;
- 2 All they think about is causing a disturbance; all they talk about is making trouble.
- 2 for their hearts plot violence, and their lips talk about making trouble.
- 3 It takes wisdom to build a house, and understanding to set it on a firm foundation;
- 3 By wisdom a house is built, and through understanding it is established;
- 4 It takes knowledge to furnish its rooms with fine furniture and beautiful draperies.
- 4 through knowledge its rooms are filled with rare and beautiful treasures.
- 5 It's better to be wise than strong; intelligence outranks muscle any day.
- 5 A wise man has great power, and a man of knowledge increases strength;
- 6 Strategic planning is the key to warfare; to win, you need a lot of good counsel.
- 6 for waging war you need guidance, and for victory many advisers.
- 7 Wise conversation is way over the head of fools; in a serious discussion they haven't a clue.
- 7 Wisdom is too high for a fool; in the assembly at the gate he has nothing to say.
- 8 The person who's always cooking up some evil soon gets a reputation as prince of rogues.
- 8 He who plots evil will be known as a schemer.
- 9 Fools incubate sin; cynics desecrate beauty.
- 9 The schemes of folly are sin, and men detest a mocker.
- 10 If you fall to pieces in a crisis, there wasn't much to you in the first place.
- 10 If you falter in times of trouble, how small is your strength!
- 11 Rescue the perishing; don't hesitate to step in and help.

- 11 Rescue those being led away to death; hold back those staggering toward slaughter.
- 12 If you say, "Hey, that's none of my business," will that get you off the hook? Someone is watching you closely, you know-- Someone not impressed with weak excuses.
- 12 If you say, "But we knew nothing about this," does not he who weighs the heart perceive it? Does not he who guards your life know it? Will he not repay each person according to what he has done?
- 13 Eat honey, dear child--it's good for you-- and delicacies that melt in your mouth.
- 13 Eat honey, my son, for it is good; honey from the comb is sweet to your taste.
- 14 Likewise knowledge, and wisdom for your soul-- Get that and your future's secured, your hope is on solid rock.
- 14 Know also that wisdom is sweet to your soul; if you find it, there is a future hope for you, and your hope will not be cut off.
- 15 Don't interfere with good people's lives; don't try to get the best of them.
- 15 Do not lie in wait like an outlaw against a righteous man's house, do not raid his dwelling place;
- 16 No matter how many times you trip them up, God-loyal people don't stay down long; Soon they're up on their feet, while the wicked end up flat on their faces.
- 16 for though a righteous man falls seven times, he rises again, but the wicked are brought down by calamity.
- 17 Don't laugh when your enemy falls; don't crow over his collapse.
- 17 Do not gloat when your enemy falls; when he stumbles, do not let your heart rejoice,
- 18 GOD might see, and become very provoked, and then take pity on his plight.
- 18 or the LORD will see and disapprove and turn his wrath away from him.
- 19 Don't bother your head with braggarts or wish you could succeed like the wicked.
- 19 Do not fret because of evil men or be envious of the wicked,
- 20 Those people have no future at all; they're headed down a dead-end street.

20 for the evil man has no future hope, and the lamp of the wicked will be snuffed out.

21 Fear GOD, dear child--respect your leaders; don't be defiant or mutinous.

21 Fear the LORD and the king, my son, and do not join with the rebellious,

22 Without warning your life can turn upside-down, and who knows how or when it might happen?

22 for those two will send sudden destruction upon them, and who knows what calamities they can bring?

23 It's wrong, very wrong, to go along with injustice.

23 These also are sayings of the wise: To show partiality in judging is not good:

24 Whoever whitewashes the wicked gets a black mark in the history books,

24 Whoever says to the guilty, "You are innocent"-- peoples will curse him and nations denounce him.

25 But whoever exposes the wicked will be thanked and rewarded.

25 But it will go well with those who convict the guilty, and rich blessing will come upon them.

26 An honest answer is like a warm hug.

26 An honest answer is like a kiss on the lips.

27 First plant your fields; then build your barn.

27 Finish your outdoor work and get your fields ready; after that, build your house.

28 Don't talk about your neighbors behind their backs-- no slander or gossip, please.

28 Do not testify against your neighbor without cause, or use your lips to deceive.

29 Don't say to anyone, "I'll get back at you for what you did to me. I'll make you pay for what you did!"

29 Do not say, "I'll do to him as he has done to me; I'll pay that man back for what he did."

30 One day I walked by the field of an old lazybones, and then passed the vineyard of a lout;

- 30 I went past the field of the sluggard, past the vineyard of the man who lacks judgment;
- 31 They were overgrown with weeds, thick with thistles, all the fences broken down.
- 31 thorns had come up everywhere, the ground was covered with weeds, and the stone wall was in ruins.
- 32 I took a long look and pondered what I saw; the fields preached me a sermon and I listened:
- 32 I applied my heart to what I observed and learned a lesson from what I saw:
- 33 "A nap here, a nap there, a day off here, a day off there, sit back, take it easy--do you know what comes next?
- 33 A little sleep, a little slumber, a little folding of the hands to rest--
- 34 Just this: You can look forward to a dirt-poor life, with poverty as your permanent houseguest!"
- 34 and poverty will come on you like a bandit and scarcity like an armed man.

Proverbs 25

MSG

NIV

- 1 There are also these proverbs of Solomon, collected by scribes of Hezekiah, king of Judah.
- 1 These are more proverbs of Solomon, copied by the men of Hezekiah king of Judah:
- 2 God delights in concealing things; scientists delight in discovering things.
- 2 It is the glory of God to conceal a matter; to search out a matter is the glory of kings.
- 3 Like the horizons for breadth and the ocean for depth, the understanding of a good leader is broad and deep.
- 3 As the heavens are high and the earth is deep, so the hearts of kings are unsearchable.
- 4 Remove impurities from the silver and the silversmith can craft a fine chalice;

- 4 Remove the dross from the silver, and out comes material for the silversmith;
- 5 Remove the wicked from leadership and authority will be credible and God-honoring.
- 5 remove the wicked from the king's presence, and his throne will be established through righteousness.
- 6 Don't work yourself into the spotlight; don't push your way into the place of prominence.
- 6 Do not exalt yourself in the king's presence, and do not claim a place among great men;
- 7 It's better to be promoted to a place of honor than face humiliation by being demoted.
- 7 it is better for him to say to you, "Come up here," than for him to humiliate you before a nobleman. What you have seen with your eyes
- 8 Don't jump to conclusions--there may be a perfectly good explanation for what you just saw.
- 8 do not bring hastily to court, for what will you do in the end if your neighbor puts you to shame?
- 9 In the heat of an argument, don't betray confidences;
- 9 If you argue your case with a neighbor, do not betray another man's confidence,
- 10 Word is sure to get around, and no one will trust you.
- 10 or he who hears it may shame you and you will never lose your bad reputation.
- 11 The right word at the right time is like a custom-made piece of jewelry,
- 11 A word aptly spoken is like apples of gold in settings of silver.
- 12 And a wise friend's timely reprimand is like a gold ring slipped on your finger.
- 12 Like an earring of gold or an ornament of fine gold is a wise man's rebuke to a listening ear.
- 13 Reliable friends who do what they say are like cool drinks in sweltering heat--refreshing!
- 13 Like the coolness of snow at harvest time is a trustworthy messenger to those who send him; he refreshes the spirit of his masters.
- 14 Like billowing clouds that bring no rain is the person who talks big but never produces.

- 14 Like clouds and wind without rain is a man who boasts of gifts he does not give.
- 15 Patient persistence pierces through indifference; gentle speech breaks down rigid defenses.
- 15 Through patience a ruler can be persuaded, and a gentle tongue can break a bone.
- 16 When you're given a box of candy, don't gulp it all down; eat too much chocolate and you'll make yourself sick;
- 16 If you find honey, eat just enough-- too much of it, and you will vomit.
- 17 And when you find a friend, don't outwear your welcome; show up at all hours and he'll soon get fed up.
- 17 Seldom set foot in your neighbor's house-- too much of you, and he will hate you.
- 18 Anyone who tells lies against the neighbors in court or on the street is a loose cannon.
- 18 Like a club or a sword or a sharp arrow is the man who gives false testimony against his neighbor.
- 19 Trusting a double-crosser when you're in trouble is like biting down on an abscessed tooth.
- 19 Like a bad tooth or a lame foot is reliance on the unfaithful in times of trouble.
- 20 Singing light songs to the heavyhearted is like pouring salt in their wounds.
- 20 Like one who takes away a garment on a cold day, or like vinegar poured on soda, is one who sings songs to a heavy heart.
- 21 If you see your enemy hungry, go buy him lunch; if he's thirsty, bring him a drink.
- 21 If your enemy is hungry, give him food to eat; if he is thirsty, give him water to drink.
- 22 Your generosity will surprise him with goodness, and GOD will look after you.
- 22 In doing this, you will heap burning coals on his head, and the LORD will reward you.
- 23 A north wind brings stormy weather, and a gossipy tongue stormy looks.
- 23 As a north wind brings rain, so a sly tongue brings angry looks.

- 24 Better to live alone in a tumbledown shack than share a mansion with a nagging spouse.
- 24 Better to live on a corner of the roof than share a house with a quarrelsome wife.
- 25 Like a cool drink of water when you're worn out and weary is a letter from a long-lost friend.
- 25 Like cold water to a weary soul is good news from a distant land.
- 26 A good person who gives in to a bad person is a muddied spring, a polluted well.
- 26 Like a muddied spring or a polluted well is a righteous man who gives way to the wicked.
- 27 It's not smart to stuff yourself with sweets, nor is glory piled on glory good for you.
- 27 It is not good to eat too much honey, nor is it honorable to seek one's own honor.
- 28 A person without self-control is like a house with its doors and windows knocked out.
- 28 Like a city whose walls are broken down is a man who lacks self-control.

Proverbs 26

MSG

NIV

- 1 We no more give honors to fools than pray for snow in summer or rain during harvest.
- 1 Like snow in summer or rain in harvest, honor is not fitting for a fool.
- 2 You have as little to fear from an undeserved curse as from the dart of a wren or the swoop of a swallow.
- 2 Like a fluttering sparrow or a darting swallow, an undeserved curse does not come to rest.
- 3 A whip for the racehorse, a tiller for the sailboat-- and a stick for the back of fools!
- 3 A whip for the horse, a halter for the donkey, and a rod for the backs of fools!
- 4 Don't respond to the stupidity of a fool; you'll only look foolish yourself.

- 4 Do not answer a fool according to his folly, or you will be like him yourself.
- 5 Answer a fool in simple terms so he doesn't get a swelled head.
- 5 Answer a fool according to his folly, or he will be wise in his own eyes.
- 6 You're only asking for trouble when you send a message by a fool.
- 6 Like cutting off one's feet or drinking violence is the sending of a message by the hand of a fool.
- 7 A proverb quoted by fools is limp as a wet noodle.
- 7 Like a lame man's legs that hang limp is a proverb in the mouth of a fool.
- 8 Putting a fool in a place of honor is like setting a mud brick on a marble column.
- 8 Like tying a stone in a sling is the giving of honor to a fool.
- 9 To ask a moron to quote a proverb is like putting a scalpel in the hands of a drunk.
- 9 Like a thornbush in a drunkard's hand is a proverb in the mouth of a fool.
- 10 Hire a fool or a drunk and you shoot yourself in the foot.
- 10 Like an archer who wounds at random is he who hires a fool or any passer-by.
- 11 As a dog eats its own vomit, so fools recycle silliness.
- 11 As a dog returns to its vomit, so a fool repeats his folly.
- 12 See that man who thinks he's so smart? You can expect far more from a fool than from him.
- 12 Do you see a man wise in his own eyes? There is more hope for a fool than for him.
- 13 Loafers say, "It's dangerous out there! Tigers are prowling the streets!" and then pull the covers back over their heads.
- 13 The sluggard says, "There is a lion in the road, a fierce lion roaming the streets!"
- 14 Just as a door turns on its hinges, so a lazybones turns back over in bed.
- 14 As a door turns on its hinges, so a sluggard turns on his bed.
- 15 A shiftless sluggard puts his fork in the pie, but is too lazy to lift it to his mouth.
- 15 The sluggard buries his hand in the dish; he is too lazy to bring it back to his mouth.
- 16 Dreamers fantasize their self-importance; they think they are smarter than a whole college faculty.

- 16 The sluggard is wiser in his own eyes than seven men who answer discreetly.
- 17 You grab a mad dog by the ears when you butt into a quarrel that's none of your business.
- 17 Like one who seizes a dog by the ears is a passer-by who meddles in a quarrel not his own.
- 18 People who shrug off deliberate deceptions, saying, "I didn't mean it, I was only joking,"
- 18 Like a madman shooting firebrands or deadly arrows
- 19 Are worse than careless campers who walk away from smoldering campfires.
- 19 is a man who deceives his neighbor and says, "I was only joking!"
- 20 When you run out of wood, the fire goes out; when the gossip ends, the quarrel dies down.
- 20 Without wood a fire goes out; without gossip a quarrel dies down.
- 21 A quarrelsome person in a dispute is like kerosene thrown on a fire.
- 21 As charcoal to embers and as wood to fire, so is a quarrelsome man for kindling strife.
- 22 Listening to gossip is like eating cheap candy; do you want junk like that in your belly?
- 22 The words of a gossip are like choice morsels; they go down to a man's inmost parts.
- 23 Smooth talk from an evil heart is like glaze on cracked pottery.
- 23 Like a coating of glaze over earthenware are fervent lips with an evil heart.
- 24 Your enemy shakes hands and greets you like an old friend, all the while conniving against you.
- 24 A malicious man disguises himself with his lips, but in his heart he harbors deceit.
- 25 When he speaks warmly to you, don't believe him for a minute; he's just waiting for the chance to rip you off.
- 25 Though his speech is charming, do not believe him, for seven abominations fill his heart.
- 26 No matter how cunningly he conceals his malice, eventually his evil will be exposed in public.

- 26 His malice may be concealed by deception, but his wickedness will be exposed in the assembly.
- 27 Malice backfires; spite boomerangs.
- 27 If a man digs a pit, he will fall into it; if a man rolls a stone, it will roll back on him.
- 28 Liars hate their victims; flatterers sabotage trust.
- 28 A lying tongue hates those it hurts, and a flattering mouth works ruin.

Proverbs 27

MSG

NIV

- 1 Don't brashly announce what you're going to do tomorrow; you don't know the first thing about tomorrow.
- 1 Do not boast about tomorrow, for you do not know what a day may bring forth.
- 2 Don't call attention to yourself; let others do that for you.
- 2 Let another praise you, and not your own mouth; someone else, and not your own lips.
- 3 Carrying a log across your shoulders while you're hefting a boulder with your arms Is nothing compared to the burden of putting up with a fool.
- 3 Stone is heavy and sand a burden, but provocation by a fool is heavier than both.
- 4 We're blasted by anger and swamped by rage, but who can survive jealousy?
- 4 Anger is cruel and fury overwhelming, but who can stand before jealousy?
- 5 A spoken reprimand is better than approval that's never expressed.
- 5 Better is open rebuke than hidden love.
- 6 The wounds from a lover are worth it; kisses from an enemy do you in.
- 6 Wounds from a friend can be trusted, but an enemy multiplies kisses.
- 7 When you've stuffed yourself, you refuse dessert; when you're starved, you could eat a horse.
- 7 He who is full loathes honey, but to the hungry even what is bitter tastes sweet.

- 8 People who won't settle down, wandering hither and yon, are like restless birds, flitting to and fro.
- 8 Like a bird that strays from its nest is a man who strays from his home.
- 9 Just as lotions and fragrance give sensual delight, a sweet friendship refreshes the soul.
- 9 Perfume and incense bring joy to the heart, and the pleasantness of one's friend springs from his earnest counsel.
- 10 Don't leave your friends or your parents' friends and run home to your family when things get rough; Better a nearby friend than a distant family.
- 10 Do not forsake your friend and the friend of your father, and do not go to your brother's house when disaster strikes you-- better a neighbor nearby than a brother far away.
- 11 Become wise, dear child, and make me happy; then nothing the world throws my way will upset me.
- 11 Be wise, my son, and bring joy to my heart; then I can answer anyone who treats me with contempt.
- 12 A prudent person sees trouble coming and ducks; a simpleton walks in blindly and is clobbered.
- 12 The prudent see danger and take refuge, but the simple keep going and suffer for it.
- 13 Hold tight to collateral on any loan to a stranger; be wary of accepting what a transient has pawned.
- 13 Take the garment of one who puts up security for a stranger; hold it in pledge if he does it for a wayward woman.
- 14 If you wake your friend in the early morning by shouting "Rise and shine!" It will sound to him more like a curse than a blessing.
- 14 If a man loudly blesses his neighbor early in the morning, it will be taken as a curse.
- 15 A nagging spouse is like the drip, drip, drip of a leaky faucet;
- 15 A quarrelsome wife is like a constant dripping on a rainy day;
- 16 You can't turn it off, and you can't get away from it.
- 16 restraining her is like restraining the wind or grasping oil with the hand.
- 17 You use steel to sharpen steel, and one friend sharpens another.
- 17 As iron sharpens iron, so one man sharpens another.

- 18 If you care for your orchard, you'll enjoy its fruit; if you honor your boss, you'll be honored.
- 18 He who tends a fig tree will eat its fruit, and he who looks after his master will be honored.
- 19 Just as water mirrors your face, so your face mirrors your heart.
- 19 As water reflects a face, so a man's heart reflects the man.
- 20 Hell has a voracious appetite, and lust just never quits.
- 20 Death and Destruction are never satisfied, and neither are the eyes of man.
- 21 The purity of silver and gold is tested by putting them in the fire; The purity of human hearts is tested by giving them a little fame.
- 21 The crucible for silver and the furnace for gold, but man is tested by the praise he receives.
- 22 Pound on a fool all you like-- you can't pound out foolishness.
- 22 Though you grind a fool in a mortar, grinding him like grain with a pestle, you will not remove his folly from him.
- 23 Know your sheep by name; carefully attend to your flocks;
- 23 Be sure you know the condition of your flocks, give careful attention to your herds;
- 24 (Don't take them for granted; possessions don't last forever, you know.)
- 24 for riches do not endure forever, and a crown is not secure for all generations.
- 25 And then, when the crops are in and the harvest is stored in the barns,
- 25 When the hay is removed and new growth appears and the grass from the hills is gathered in,
- 26 You can knit sweaters from lambs' wool, and sell your goats for a profit;
- 26 the lambs will provide you with clothing, and the goats with the price of a field.
- 27 There will be plenty of milk and meat to last your family through the winter.
- 27 You will have plenty of goats' milk to feed you and your family and to nourish your servant girls.

Proverbs 28

MSG

NIV

- 1 The wicked are edgy with guilt, ready to run off even when no one's after them; Honest people are relaxed and confident, bold as lions.
- 1 The wicked man flees though no one pursues, but the righteous are as bold as a lion.
- 2 When the country is in chaos, everybody has a plan to fix it-- But it takes a leader of real understanding to straighten things out.
- 2 When a country is rebellious, it has many rulers, but a man of understanding and knowledge maintains order.
- 3 The wicked who oppress the poor are like a hailstorm that beats down the harvest.
- 3 A ruler who oppresses the poor is like a driving rain that leaves no crops.
- 4 If you desert God's law, you're free to embrace depravity; if you love God's law, you fight for it tooth and nail.
- 4 Those who forsake the law praise the wicked, but those who keep the law resist them.
- 5 Justice makes no sense to the evilminded; those who seek GOD know it inside and out.
- 5 Evil men do not understand justice, but those who seek the LORD understand it fully.
- 6 It's better to be poor and direct than rich and crooked.
- 6 Better a poor man whose walk is blameless than a rich man whose ways are perverse.
- 7 Practice God's law--get a reputation for wisdom; hang out with a loose crowd--embarrass your family.
- 7 He who keeps the law is a discerning son, but a companion of gluttons disgraces his father.
- 8 Get as rich as you want through cheating and extortion, But eventually some friend of the poor is going to give it all back to them.
- 8 He who increases his wealth by exorbitant interest amasses it for another, who will be kind to the poor.
- 9 God has no use for the prayers of the people who won't listen to him.
- 9 If anyone turns a deaf ear to the law, even his prayers are detestable.
- 10 Lead good people down a wrong path and you'll come to a bad end; do good and you'll be rewarded for it.

- 10 He who leads the upright along an evil path will fall into his own trap, but the blameless will receive a good inheritance.
- 11 The rich think they know it all, but the poor can see right through them.
- 11 A rich man may be wise in his own eyes, but a poor man who has discernment sees through him.
- 12 When good people are promoted, everything is great, but when the bad are in charge, watch out!
- 12 When the righteous triumph, there is great elation; but when the wicked rise to power, men go into hiding.
- 13 You can't whitewash your sins and get by with it; you find mercy by admitting and leaving them.
- 13 He who conceals his sins does not prosper, but whoever confesses and renounces them finds mercy.
- 14 A tenderhearted person lives a blessed life; a hardhearted person lives a hard life.
- 14 Blessed is the man who always fears the LORD, but he who hardens his heart falls into trouble.
- 15 Lions roar and bears charge-- and the wicked lord it over the poor.
- 15 Like a roaring lion or a charging bear is a wicked man ruling over a helpless people.
- 16 Among leaders who lack insight, abuse abounds, but for one who hates corruption, the future is bright.
- 16 A tyrannical ruler lacks judgment, but he who hates ill-gotten gain will enjoy a long life.
- 17 A murderer haunted by guilt is doomed--there's no helping him.
- 17 A man tormented by the guilt of murder will be a fugitive till death; let no one support him.
- 18 Walk straight--live well and be saved; a devious life is a doomed life.
- 18 He whose walk is blameless is kept safe, but he whose ways are perverse will suddenly fall.
- 19 Work your garden--you'll end up with plenty of food; play and party--you'll end up with an empty plate.
- 19 He who works his land will have abundant food, but the one who chases fantasies will have his fill of poverty.
- 20 Committed and persistent work pays off; get-rich-quick schemes are ripoffs.

- 20 A faithful man will be richly blessed, but one eager to get rich will not go unpunished.
- 21 Playing favorites is always a bad thing; you can do great harm in seemingly harmless ways.
- 21 To show partiality is not good-- yet a man will do wrong for a piece of bread.
- 22 A miser in a hurry to get rich doesn't know that he'll end up broke.
- 22 A stingy man is eager to get rich and is unaware that poverty awaits him.
- 23 In the end, serious reprimand is appreciated far more than bootlicking flattery.
- 23 He who rebukes a man will in the end gain more favor than he who has a flattering tongue.
- 24 Anyone who robs father and mother and says, "So, what's wrong with that?" is worse than a pirate.
- 24 He who robs his father or mother and says, "It's not wrong"-- he is partner to him who destroys.
- 25 A grasping person stirs up trouble, but trust in GOD brings a sense of well-being.
- 25 A greedy man stirs up dissension, but he who trusts in the LORD will prosper.
- 26 If you think you know it all, you're a fool for sure; real survivors learn wisdom from others.
- 26 He who trusts in himself is a fool, but he who walks in wisdom is kept safe.
- 27 Be generous to the poor--you'll never go hungry; shut your eyes to their needs, and run a gauntlet of curses.
- 27 He who gives to the poor will lack nothing, but he who closes his eyes to them receives many curses.
- 28 When corruption takes over, good people go underground, but when the crooks are thrown out, it's safe to come out.
- 28 When the wicked rise to power, people go into hiding; but when the wicked perish, the righteous thrive.

Proverbs 29

MSG

NIV

- 1 For people who hate discipline and only get more stubborn, There'll come a day when life tumbles in and they break, but by then it'll be too late to help them.
- 1 A man who remains stiff-necked after many rebukes will suddenly be destroyed--without remedy.
- 2 When good people run things, everyone is glad, but when the ruler is bad, everyone groans.
- 2 When the righteous thrive, the people rejoice; when the wicked rule, the people groan.
- 3 If you love wisdom, you'll delight your parents, but you'll destroy their trust if you run with whores.
- 3 A man who loves wisdom brings joy to his father, but a companion of prostitutes squanders his wealth.
- 4 A leader of good judgment gives stability; an exploiting leader leaves a trail of waste.
- 4 By justice a king gives a country stability, but one who is greedy for bribes tears it down.
- 5 A flattering neighbor is up to no good; he's probably planning to take advantage of you.
- 5 Whoever flatters his neighbor is spreading a net for his feet.
- 6 Evil people fall into their own traps; good people run the other way, glad to escape.
- 6 An evil man is snared by his own sin, but a righteous one can sing and be glad.
- 7 The good-hearted understand what it's like to be poor; the hardhearted haven't the faintest idea.
- 7 The righteous care about justice for the poor, but the wicked have no such concern.
- 8 A gang of cynics can upset a whole city; a group of sages can calm everyone down.
- 8 Mockers stir up a city, but wise men turn away anger.
- 9 A sage trying to work things out with a fool gets only scorn and sarcasm for his trouble.

- 9 If a wise man goes to court with a fool, the fool rages and scoffs, and there is no peace.
- 10 Murderers hate honest people; moral folks encourage them.
- 10 Bloodthirsty men hate a man of integrity and seek to kill the upright.
- 11 A fool lets it all hang out; a sage quietly mulls it over.
- 11 A fool gives full vent to his anger, but a wise man keeps himself under control.
- 12 When a leader listens to malicious gossip, all the workers get infected with evil.
- 12 If a ruler listens to lies, all his officials become wicked.
- 13 The poor and their abusers have at least something in common: they can both see--their sight, GOD's gift!
- 13 The poor man and the oppressor have this in common: The LORD gives sight to the eyes of both.
- 14 Leadership gains authority and respect when the voiceless poor are treated fairly.
- 14 If a king judges the poor with fairness, his throne will always be secure.
- 15 Wise discipline imparts wisdom; spoiled adolescents embarrass their parents.
- 15 The rod of correction imparts wisdom, but a child left to himself disgraces his mother.
- 16 When degenerates take charge, crime runs wild, but the righteous will eventually observe their collapse.
- 16 When the wicked thrive, so does sin, but the righteous will see their downfall.
- 17 Discipline your children; you'll be glad you did-- they'll turn out delightful to live with.
- 17 Discipline your son, and he will give you peace; he will bring delight to your soul.
- 18 If people can't see what God is doing, they stumble all over themselves; But when they attend to what he reveals, they are most blessed.
- 18 Where there is no revelation, the people cast off restraint; but blessed is he who keeps the law.
- 19 It takes more than talk to keep workers in line; mere words go in one ear and out the other.

- 19 A servant cannot be corrected by mere words; though he understands, he will not respond.
- 20 Observe the people who always talk before they think-- even simpletons are better off than they are.
- 20 Do you see a man who speaks in haste? There is more hope for a fool than for him.
- 21 If you let people treat you like a doormat, you'll be quite forgotten in the end.
- 21 If a man pampers his servant from youth, he will bring grief in the end.
- 22 Angry people stir up a lot of discord; the intemperate stir up trouble.
- 22 An angry man stirs up dissension, and a hot-tempered one commits many sins.
- 23 Pride lands you flat on your face; humility prepares you for honors.
- 23 A man's pride brings him low, but a man of lowly spirit gains honor.
- 24 Befriend an outlaw and become an enemy to yourself. When the victims cry out, you'll be included in their curses if you're a coward to their cause in court.
- 24 The accomplice of a thief is his own enemy; he is put under oath and dare not testify.
- 25 The fear of human opinion disables; trusting in GOD protects you from that.
- 25 Fear of man will prove to be a snare, but whoever trusts in the LORD is kept safe.
- 26 Everyone tries to get help from the leader, but only GOD will give us justice.
- 26 Many seek an audience with a ruler, but it is from the LORD that man gets justice.
- 27 Good people can't stand the sight of deliberate evil; the wicked can't stand the sight of well-chosen goodness.
- 27 The righteous detest the dishonest; the wicked detest the upright.

Proverbs 30

MSG

NIV

- 1 The skeptic swore, "There is no God! No God!--I can do anything I want!

- 1 The sayings of Agur son of Jakeh--an oracle: This man declared to Ithiel, to Ithiel and to Ucal:
- 2 I'm more animal than human; so-called human intelligence escapes me.
- 2 I am the most ignorant of men; I do not have a man's understanding.
- 3 "I flunked 'wisdom.' I see no evidence of a holy God.
- 3 I have not learned wisdom, nor have I knowledge of the Holy One.
- 4 Has anyone ever seen Anyone climb into Heaven and take charge? grab the winds and control them? gather the rains in his bucket? stake out the ends of the earth? Just tell me his name, tell me the names of his sons. Come on now--tell me!"
- 4 Who has gone up to heaven and come down? Who has gathered up the wind in the hollow of his hands? Who has wrapped up the waters in his cloak? Who has established all the ends of the earth? What is his name, and the name of his son? Tell me if you know!
- 5 The believer replied, "Every promise of God proves true; he protects everyone who runs to him for help.
- 5 Every word of God is flawless; he is a shield to those who take refuge in him.
- 6 So don't second-guess him; he might take you to task and show up your lies."
- 6 Do not add to his words, or he will rebuke you and prove you a liar.
- 7 And then he prayed, "God, I'm asking for two things before I die; don't refuse me--
- 7 Two things I ask of you, O LORD; do not refuse me before I die:
- 8 Banish lies from my lips and liars from my presence. Give me enough food to live on, neither too much nor too little.
- 8 Keep falsehood and lies far from me; give me neither poverty nor riches, but give me only my daily bread.
- 9 If I'm too full, I might get independent, saying, 'God? Who needs him?' If I'm poor, I might steal and dishonor the name of my God."
- 9 Otherwise, I may have too much and disown you and say, 'Who is the LORD?' Or I may become poor and steal, and so dishonor the name of my God.
- 10 Don't blow the whistle on your fellow workers behind their backs; They'll accuse you of being underhanded, and then you'll be the guilty

one!

- 10 Do not slander a servant to his master, or he will curse you, and you will pay for it.
- 11 Don't curse your father or fail to bless your mother.
- 11 There are those who curse their fathers and do not bless their mothers;
- 12 Don't imagine yourself to be quite presentable when you haven't had a bath in weeks.
- 12 those who are pure in their own eyes and yet are not cleansed of their filth;
- 13 Don't be stuck-up and think you're better than everyone else.
- 13 those whose eyes are ever so haughty, whose glances are so disdainful;
- 14 Don't be greedy, merciless and cruel as wolves, Tearing into the poor and feasting on them, shredding the needy to pieces only to discard them.
- 14 those whose teeth are swords and whose jaws are set with knives to devour the poor from the earth, the needy from among mankind.
- 15 A leech has twin daughters named "Gimme" and "Gimme more." Three things are never satisfied, no, there are four that never say, "That's enough, thank you!"--
- 15 The leech has two daughters. 'Give! Give!' they cry. There are three things that are never satisfied, four that never say, 'Enough!':
- 16 hell, a barren womb, a parched land, a forest fire.
- 16 the grave, the barren womb, land, which is never satisfied with water, and fire, which never says, 'Enough!'
- 17 An eye that disdains a father and despises a mother-- that eye will be plucked out by wild vultures and consumed by young eagles.
- 17 The eye that mocks a father, that scorns obedience to a mother, will be pecked out by the ravens of the valley, will be eaten by the vultures.
- 18 Three things amaze me, no, four things I'll never understand--
- 18 There are three things that are too amazing for me, four that I do not understand:
- 19 how an eagle flies so high in the sky, how a snake glides over a rock, how a ship navigates the ocean, why adolescents act the way they do.
- 19 the way of an eagle in the sky, the way of a snake on a rock, the way of a ship on the high seas, and the way of a man with a maiden.

20 Here's how a prostitute operates: she has sex with her client, Takes a bath, then asks, "Who's next?"

20 This is the way of an adulteress: She eats and wipes her mouth and says, 'I've done nothing wrong.'

21 Three things are too much for even the earth to bear, yes, four things shake its foundations--

21 Under three things the earth trembles, under four it cannot bear up:

22 when the janitor becomes the boss, when a fool gets rich,

22 a servant who becomes king, a fool who is full of food,

23 when a whore is voted "woman of the year," when a "girlfriend" replaces a faithful wife.

23 an unloved woman who is married, and a maidservant who displaces her mistress.

24 There are four small creatures, wisest of the wise they are--

24 Four things on earth are small, yet they are extremely wise:

25 ants--frail as they are, get plenty of food in for the winter;

25 Ants are creatures of little strength, yet they store up their food in the summer;

26 marmots--vulnerable as they are, manage to arrange for rock-solid homes;

26 coneys are creatures of little power, yet they make their home in the crags;

27 locusts--leaderless insects, yet they strip the field like an army regiment;

27 locusts have no king, yet they advance together in ranks;

28 lizards--easy enough to catch, but they sneak past vigilant palace guards.

28 a lizard can be caught with the hand, yet it is found in kings' palaces.

29 There are three solemn dignitaries, four that are impressive in their bearing--

29 There are three things that are stately in their stride, four that move with stately bearing:

30 a lion, king of the beasts, deferring to none;

30 a lion, mighty among beasts, who retreats before nothing;

31 a rooster, proud and strutting; a billy goat; a head of state in stately procession.

31 a strutting rooster, a he-goat, and a king with his army around him.

- 32 If you're dumb enough to call attention to yourself by offending people and making rude gestures,
32 If you have played the fool and exalted yourself, or if you have planned evil, clap your hand over your mouth!
33 Don't be surprised if someone bloodies your nose. Churned milk turns into butter; riled emotions turn into fist fights.
33 For as churning the milk produces butter, and as twisting the nose produces blood, so stirring up anger produces strife."

Proverbs 31

MSG

NIV

- 1 The words of King Lemuel, the strong advice his mother gave him:
1 The sayings of King Lemuel--an oracle his mother taught him:
2 "Oh, son of mine, what can you be thinking of! Child whom I bore! The son I dedicated to God!
2 O my son, O son of my womb, O son of my vows,
3 Don't dissipate your virility on fortune-hunting women, promiscuous women who shipwreck leaders.
3 do not spend your strength on women, your vigor on those who ruin kings.
4 "Leaders can't afford to make fools of themselves, gulping wine and swilling beer,
4 It is not for kings, O Lemuel-- not for kings to drink wine, not for rulers to crave beer,
5 Lest, hung over, they don't know right from wrong, and the people who depend on them are hurt.
5 lest they drink and forget what the law decrees, and deprive all the oppressed of their rights.
6 Use wine and beer only as sedatives, to kill the pain and dull the ache
6 Give beer to those who are perishing, wine to those who are in anguish;
7 Of the terminally ill, for whom life is a living death.
7 let them drink and forget their poverty and remember their misery no more.

- 8 "Speak up for the people who have no voice, for the rights of all the down-and-outers.
- 8 Speak up for those who cannot speak for themselves, for the rights of all who are destitute.
- 9 Speak out for justice! Stand up for the poor and destitute!"
- 9 Speak up and judge fairly; defend the rights of the poor and needy."
- 10 A good woman is hard to find, and worth far more than diamonds.
- 10 A wife of noble character who can find? She is worth far more than rubies.
- 11 Her husband trusts her without reserve, and never has reason to regret it.
- 11 Her husband has full confidence in her and lacks nothing of value.
- 12 Never spiteful, she treats him generously all her life long.
- 12 She brings him good, not harm, all the days of her life.
- 13 She shops around for the best yarns and cottons, and enjoys knitting and sewing.
- 13 She selects wool and flax and works with eager hands.
- 14 She's like a trading ship that sails to faraway places and brings back exotic surprises.
- 14 She is like the merchant ships, bringing her food from afar.
- 15 She's up before dawn, preparing breakfast for her family and organizing her day.
- 15 She gets up while it is still dark; she provides food for her family and portions for her servant girls.
- 16 She looks over a field and buys it, then, with money she's put aside, plants a garden.
- 16 She considers a field and buys it; out of her earnings she plants a vineyard.
- 17 First thing in the morning, she dresses for work, rolls up her sleeves, eager to get started.
- 17 She sets about her work vigorously; her arms are strong for her tasks.
- 18 She senses the worth of her work, is in no hurry to call it quits for the day.
- 18 She sees that her trading is profitable, and her lamp does not go out at night.
- 19 She's skilled in the crafts of home and hearth, diligent in homemaking.
- 19 In her hand she holds the distaff and grasps the spindle with her fingers.

- 20 She's quick to assist anyone in need, reaches out to help the poor.
- 20 She opens her arms to the poor and extends her hands to the needy.
- 21 She doesn't worry about her family when it snows; their winter clothes are all mended and ready to wear.
- 21 When it snows, she has no fear for her household; for all of them are clothed in scarlet.
- 22 She makes her own clothing, and dresses in colorful linens and silks.
- 22 She makes coverings for her bed; she is clothed in fine linen and purple.
- 23 Her husband is greatly respected when he deliberates with the city fathers.
- 23 Her husband is respected at the city gate, where he takes his seat among the elders of the land.
- 24 She designs gowns and sells them, brings the sweaters she knits to the dress shops.
- 24 She makes linen garments and sells them, and supplies the merchants with sashes.
- 25 Her clothes are well-made and elegant, and she always faces tomorrow with a smile.
- 25 She is clothed with strength and dignity; she can laugh at the days to come.
- 26 When she speaks she has something worthwhile to say, and she always says it kindly.
- 26 She speaks with wisdom, and faithful instruction is on her tongue.
- 27 She keeps an eye on everyone in her household, and keeps them all busy and productive.
- 27 She watches over the affairs of her household and does not eat the bread of idleness.
- 28 Her children respect and bless her; her husband joins in with words of praise:
- 28 Her children arise and call her blessed; her husband also, and he praises her:
- 29 "Many women have done wonderful things, but you've outclassed them all!"
- 29 Many women do noble things, but you surpass them all.
- 30 Charm can mislead and beauty soon fades. The woman to be admired and praised is the woman who lives in the Fear-of-GOD.

- 30 Charm is deceptive, and beauty is fleeting; but a woman who fears the LORD is to be praised.
- 31 Give her everything she deserves! Festoon her life with praises!
- 31 Give her the reward she has earned, and let her works bring her praise at the city gate.